

ESC-201 Mechanics of Materials Notes

The main idea of this course is to understand how mechanisms and designs perform under various loads and conditions. We will combine force loading from statics and dynamics with material properties to quantify the performance of a design and see how it fails.

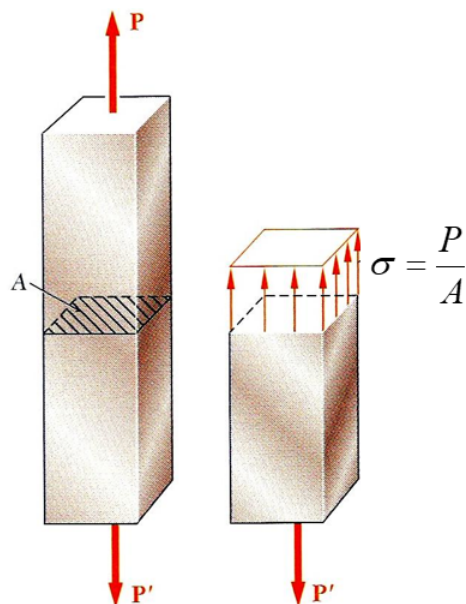
Basic Concepts

Normal Stress

When load is applied normal to a cross-section such as the one below, we can find the normal stress applied by dividing the force by the area of the cross-section. This represents the *average* normal stress, as the actual stress distribution is usually not uniform across the cross-section. It can be thought similarly to pressure, which both represents a load over an area.

$$\sigma_{\text{avg}} = \frac{P}{A}$$

Sign convention: A positive stress corresponds to **ten-**sile loading while a negative stress corresponds to **com-**pressive loading.

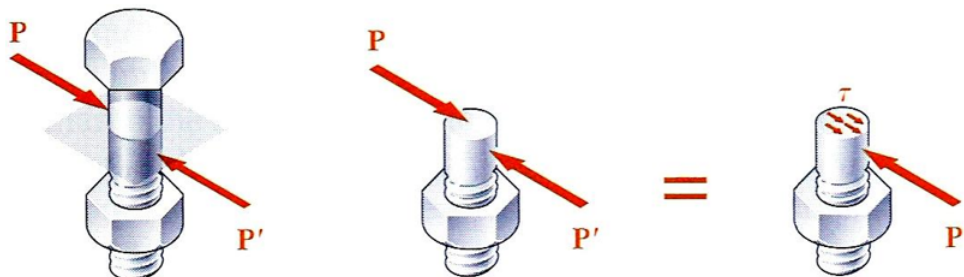


Shear Stress

When load is applied parallel or along a cross-section, we can find the shear stress by dividing the force by the area of the cross-section. Similar to normal stress, this represents the *average* shear stress, as the actual stress distribution is usually not uniform across the cross-section.

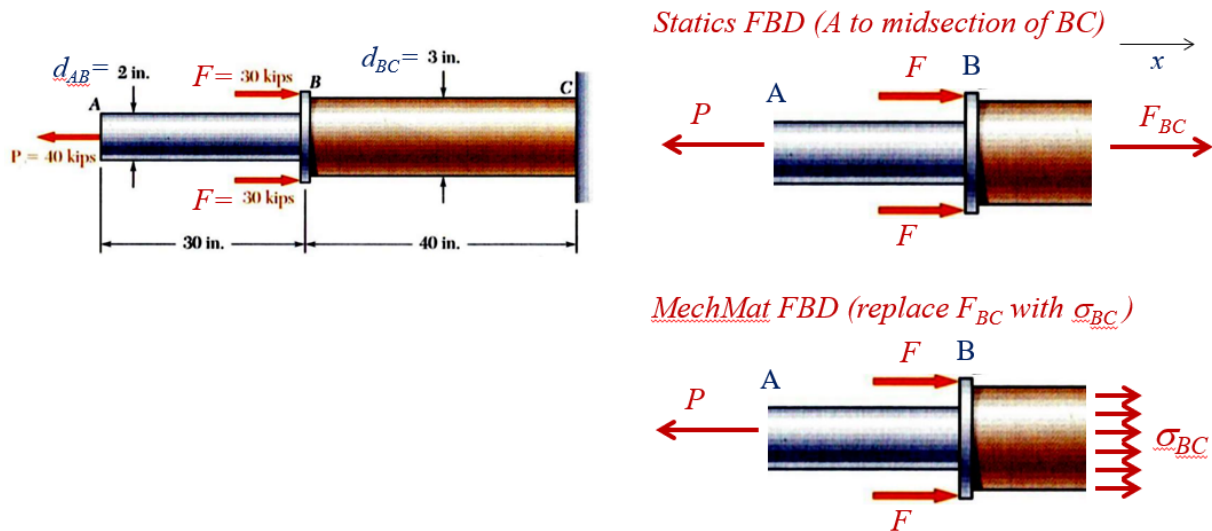
$$\tau_{\text{avg}} = \frac{P}{A}$$

Here, P' represents the internal reaction load due to the applied load P .



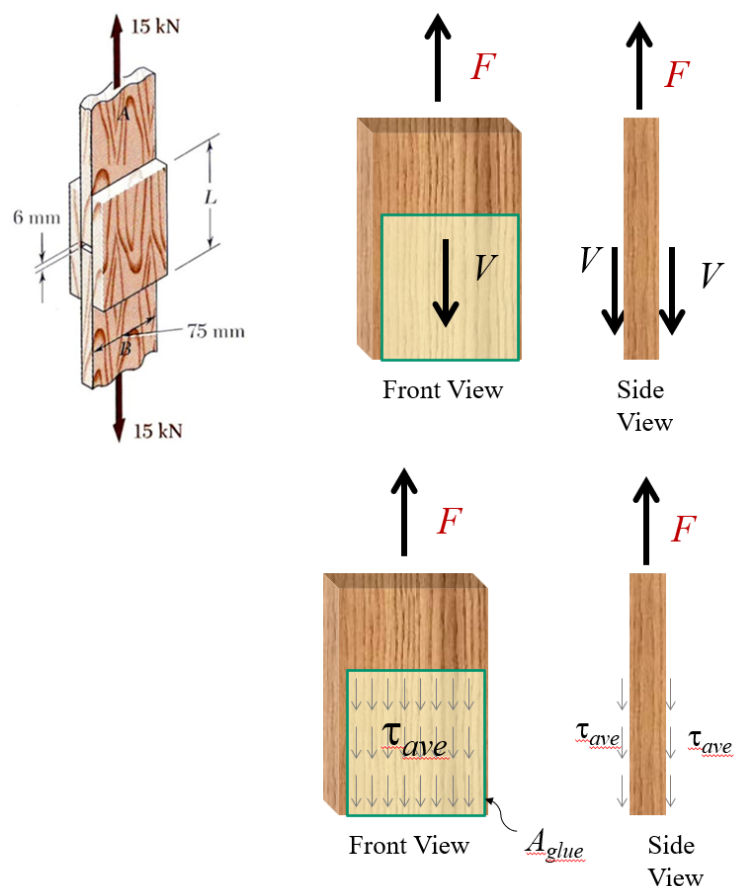
Sign convention: It follows the sign of the applied force. (ie. If the force is in the positive direction, the shear stress is positive.)

Note: It is sometimes useful to think of stress as substitutions for forces. For example, we can draw two different FBDs, one showing the forces and one showing the stresses.



This way, it is clear to see what force corresponds to what stress and what area it acts on.

This is representative of our problem-solving approach. Starting from static force balances to solve for the forces, then using those forces to find the stresses, and finally using the stresses to find the strains and deformations.



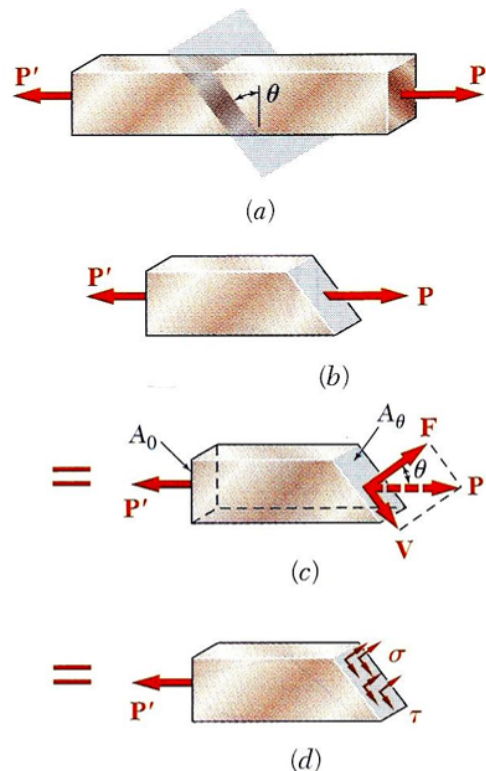
General Stress

When either the load is applied at an angle or the cross-section is not perpendicular to the load, we can always decompose the load into a normal and shear component. Then we can define the normal and shear stresses as before.

$$\sigma = \frac{F}{A_\theta} = \frac{P \cos \theta}{A_0 / \cos \theta} = \frac{P \cos^2 \theta}{A_0}$$

$$\tau = \frac{V}{A_\theta} = \frac{P \sin \theta}{A_0 / \cos \theta} = \frac{P \sin \theta \cos \theta}{A_0}$$

Where A_0 is the area of the cross-section perpendicular to the load/axis and A_θ is the area of the cross-section at an angle θ to the load/axis.



Pinned Joints

When considering a pinned joint and how it fails, there are several ways. Mainly, it depends on whether the load is tensile or compressive. For both cases, the average normal stress at the midsection matters, but it's not usually where failure *first* occurs, or in other words, it's not a critical region (where stress is max). The following are the critical regions unique to the type of loading:

• Member in Tension

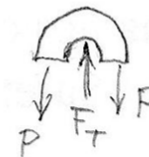
Under tension, failure can occur by the member splitting at the shoulders around the pin where the cross-sectional area is smallest.

$$\sigma_{\text{avg}_{\text{max}}} = \frac{F_T}{A_{\text{min}}} \quad (\text{max average normal stress})$$

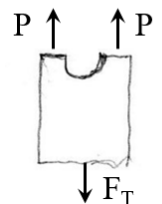
Where A_{min} is the minimum cross-sectional area of the member, which is usually defined by $(w - d)t$ where w is the width of the member, d is the diameter of the pin, and t is the thickness of the member.

Cut member at Pin:

End:



Midsection:

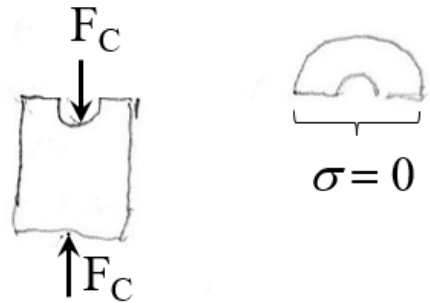


- **Member in Compression**

Under compression, the pin squishes into the member and effectively becomes a solid piece. Thus, the risk isn't at the shoulders but rather at the midsection where it could buckle. Note that there is ZERO stress at the upper region around the hole since there is no load there.

$$\sigma_{\text{avg}} = \frac{F_C}{A_{\text{cross-section}}} \quad (\text{the usual average normal stress})$$

Cut member at Pin:



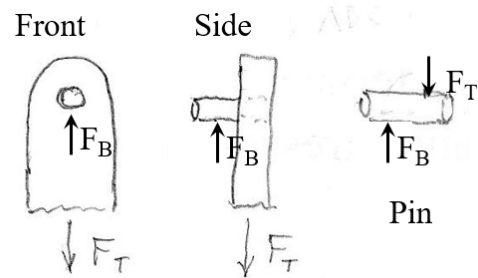
For both cases, we need to also consider the shear stress on the pin and also the bearing stress on the member.

Shear Stress at Pin

The first place failure can occur is that the pin shears. In this case, the pin is in *single shear*. This is the same for both tension and compression.

$$\tau_{\text{avg}} = \frac{F_T}{A_{\text{pin}}}$$

Where A_{pin} is the cross-sectional area of the pin.



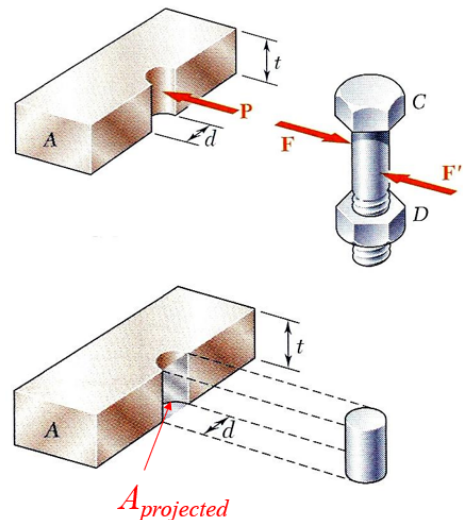
Bearing Stress

Another place failure can occur is that the hole the pin rests upon physically deforms and causes failure. This is called bearing stress, and it is always a compressive stress (the pin pushes into the hole).

It is also an average stress, but it uses the projected area of the bolt onto the hole:

$$\sigma_{\text{avg}} = \frac{P}{A_{\text{projected}}} = \frac{P}{td}$$

Sign convention: Like mentioned before, this is always a compressive stress, so we report it as a positive value.



Factor of Safety and Stresses

Factor of Safety

The factor of safety (FS) accounts for uncertainties in loading, material properties, and approximations such as uniform stress assumptions. It is defined as:

$$\text{FS} = \frac{\text{Ultimate Load}}{\text{Allowable Load}}$$

where the ultimate load is the load at failure and the allowable load is the maximum design load. If failure occurs when the applied stress reaches the material failure strength:

$$\text{FS} = \frac{\sigma_{\text{fail}}}{\sigma_{\text{allowable}}}$$

where $\sigma_{\text{fail}} = \sigma_{\text{ult}}$ when designing against ultimate failure, or $\sigma_{\text{fail}} = \sigma_{\text{yield}}$ when designing against yielding.

Stress Concentrations

When geometric discontinuities are present, the stress concentration factor K relates the maximum localized stress to the nominal average stress:

$$\sigma_{\text{max}} = K\sigma_{\text{ave,max}} = K \frac{F_{\text{allowable}}}{A_{\text{min}}} \quad (\text{valid for } \sigma_{\text{max}} \leq \sigma_{\text{yield}})$$

To prevent yielding at the stress concentration, the allowable load is constrained by setting $\sigma_{\text{max}} \leq \sigma_{\text{allowable}} = \frac{\sigma_{\text{yield}}}{\text{FS}}$, which yields:

$$\text{FS} = \frac{\sigma_{\text{yield}}}{\sigma_{\text{max}}} = \frac{\sigma_{\text{yield}}}{K\sigma_{\text{ave,max}}} = \frac{\sigma_{\text{yield}}A_{\text{min}}}{KF_{\text{allowable}}}$$

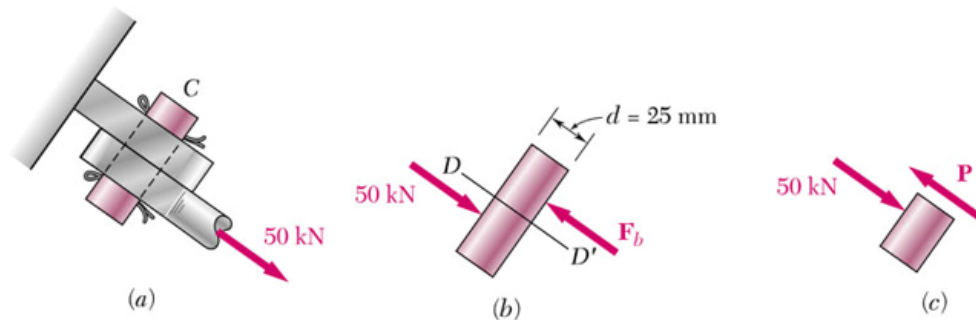
Shear in Pin or Bolt

We've already mentioned single shear as a mode of failure for pinned joints, but here it is again:

Single Shear

Single shear means that there is one member per side of the pin, such that the shear load is *equal* to the member/applied load.

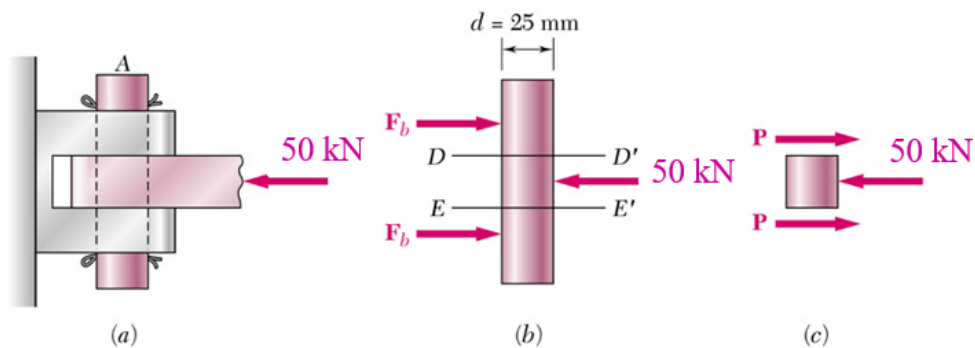
$$\tau_{\text{avg}} = \frac{\text{load}}{\text{pin XC area}}$$



Double Shear

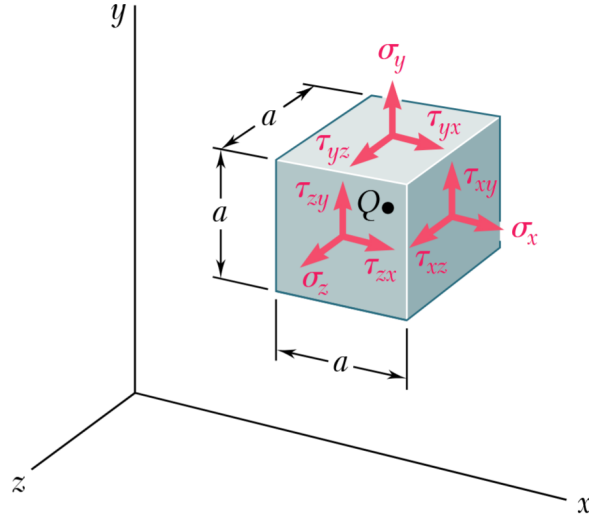
Double shear means shear is carried on both sides of incoming member (clevis joint) such that the load is split between two sides of clevis.

$$\tau_{\text{avg}} = \frac{\text{load}/2}{\text{pin XC area}}$$



3D State of Stress

Consider an infinitesimal cube of material that is internal to a member under load with side lengths a much smaller than the member. All the normal and shear stresses on the faces are *internal* stresses exerted by the surrounding material and not the applied load.



The cube is in equilibrium, so the forces on each face must balance out. Thus, we only need to define the stresses on the positive faces, and the stresses on the negative faces will be of equal magnitude but opposite direction.

There are 3 normal stresses σ_i

- i is the direction of the outward normal vector of the face (face direction)
- i is also the direction of the force (by definition of normal stress)

There are 6 shear stresses τ_{ij}

- i is the direction of the outward normal vector of the face (face direction)
- j is the direction of the force (perpendicular to the face direction by definition of shear stress)

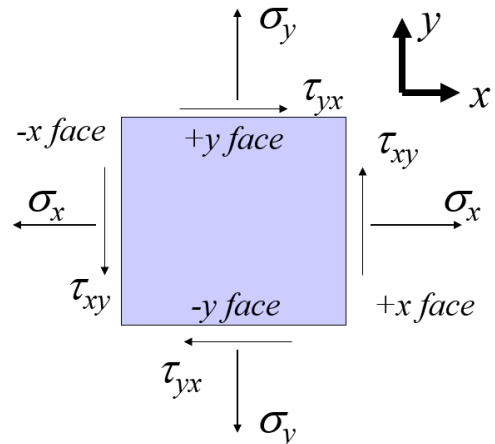
Note: Define a coordinate system and be consistent with the directions of the normal and shear stresses (point along the positive direction of the coordinate system).

Stress on the Negative Faces

The cube of material is in equilibrium, so the forces on each face must balance out. Since each face has the same area, the corresponding stresses must also balance.

$$\sum F_x = 0 \implies \sigma_x - \sigma_x + \tau_{xy} - \tau_{xy} = 0$$

$$\sum F_y = 0 \implies \sigma_y - \sigma_y + \tau_{yx} - \tau_{yx} = 0$$



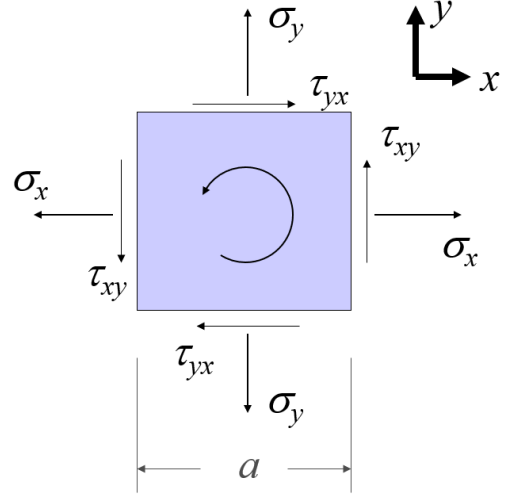
Shear Stress Symmetry

Building on the equilibrium of the cube, the moments must also balance out. Thus, we can define a shear stress symmetry:

$$\begin{aligned}\sum M_z = 0 &\implies 2\tau_{xy} \left(\frac{a}{2}\right) a^2 - 2\tau_{yx} \left(\frac{a}{2}\right) a^2 = 0 \\ &\implies \tau_{xy} = \tau_{yx}\end{aligned}$$

Therefore,

$\tau_{yx} = \tau_{xy}$
$\tau_{zx} = \tau_{xz}$
$\tau_{zy} = \tau_{yz}$



Note: Shear stress symmetry holds even with acceleration and angular acceleration (non-equilibrium) since the moments from the inertial forces still balance out (as length $a \rightarrow 0$).

$$\begin{aligned}\sum M_z &= I_{zz}\alpha \\ \sum M_z &= 2\tau_{xy} \left(\frac{a}{2}\right) a^2 - 2\tau_{yx} \left(\frac{a}{2}\right) a^2 \\ I_{zz} &= \frac{1}{6}ma^2 = \frac{1}{6}\rho a^5 \\ &\Rightarrow a^3(\tau_{xy} - \tau_{yx}) = \rho a^5\alpha\end{aligned}$$

Limit as $a \rightarrow 0$

$$\begin{aligned}\tau_{yx} - \tau_{xy} &= \rho a^2\alpha \rightarrow 0 \\ \tau_{yx} &= \tau_{xy}\end{aligned}$$

Axial Loading and Deformation

This is going to be a long section, we finally introduce strain and deformation, allowing us to find things such as thermal stress, and solve for statically indeterminate problems.

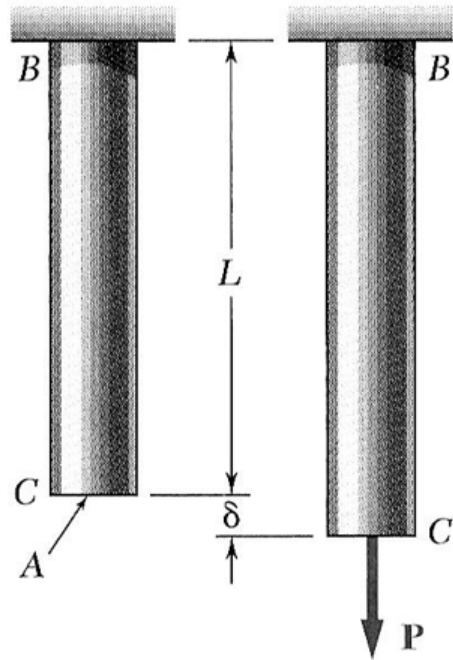
Axial Strain

If deflection δ is defined as the change in length of a member (usually by some load), then we can define the axial strain as the amount of deflection per unit length. It is a dimensionless quantity.

$$\varepsilon = \frac{\delta}{L} \quad (\text{uniform strain})$$

For a general member, we can define the limit

$$\varepsilon = \lim_{\delta \rightarrow 0} \frac{\Delta\delta}{\Delta L} = \frac{d\delta}{dL} \quad (\text{local strain})$$



Axial Deflection

In the elastic region below the yield stress, we can use Hooke's Law to relate the axial stress to the axial strain using the **Young's Modulus** or **modulus of elasticity** E .

$$\sigma = E\varepsilon$$

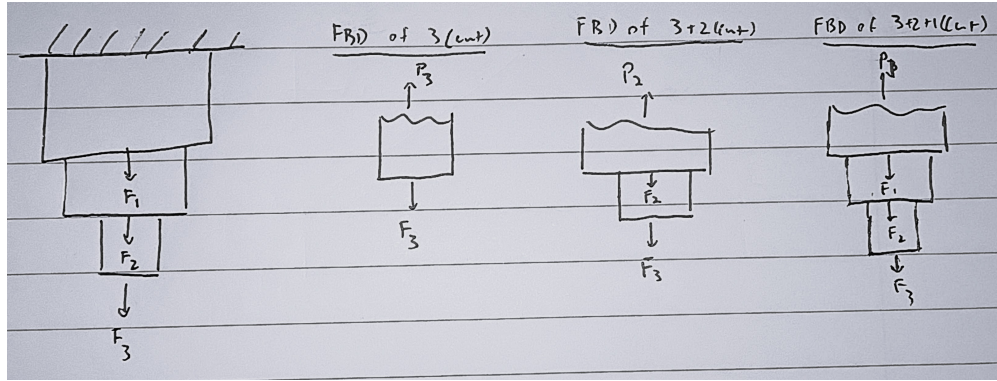
Thus, we can define the **axial deflection** as

$$\delta = \frac{PL}{EA}$$

and **stiffness** of the member as

$$k = \frac{P}{\delta} = \frac{EA}{L}$$

Note that P is an *internal* reaction force, not the applied load, so we must first solve for the internal forces using static force balances.



Thus, we can generalize for non-uniform members by integrating over the length of the member:

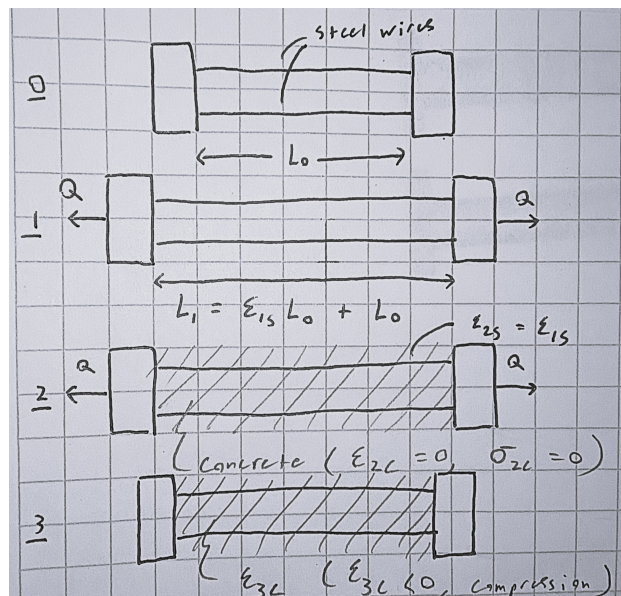
$$\delta = \sum \frac{P_i L_i}{E_i A_i} = \int_0^L \frac{P}{EA} dx$$

Statically Indeterminate Problems

The nice thing about having a deflection formula is that we can now apply constraints on the deflection to solve for unknown forces. A useful analogy here is to think of the members as springs. In some cases, the members are in series where the total length is constant ($\delta_1 + \delta_2 = 0$), and in some cases, the members are in parallel where the deflection is constant ($\delta_1 = \delta_2$). We can use these constraints to solve for unknown forces and then find the stresses and strains as usual.

Prestressed Concrete

Since concrete is stronger in compression than in tension, it is common to *preload* the concrete with a compressive force (from embedded steel wires). It works by the following process:



Initially (state 0), there is no concrete and the steel wires are at length L_0 .

1. Pre-tensioning: The steel wires are stretched to a length L_1 by a load Q and then fixed in place. This creates a strain

$$\varepsilon_{1s} = \frac{\sigma_{1s}}{E_s} = \frac{Q}{A_s E_s}$$

2. Casting: While the wires are held under tension, concrete is poured around them and allowed to set (harden). At this moment, the concrete has zero stress and zero strain, but it is now bonded to the stretched wires.
3. Release: The external load Q is removed. The steel wires want to shrink back to their original length, but the hardened concrete is in the way. Thus, as the steel contracts slightly, it pushes against the concrete, putting the concrete into compression.

Thus, the strain of the steel and concrete in state 3 must satisfy this constraint equation, with the **concrete strain negative** due to compression and the **steel strain positive** due to tension.

$$\varepsilon_{3s} = \varepsilon_{2s} + \varepsilon_{3c}$$

To determine the loads applied to each material, we use static equilibrium and express the loads in terms of Hooke's law.

$$P_s + P_c = 0$$

$$P_s = E_s A_s \varepsilon_{3s} = E_s A_s (\varepsilon_{2s} + \varepsilon_{3c}), \quad P_c = E_c A_c \varepsilon_{3c}$$

Thermal Stress

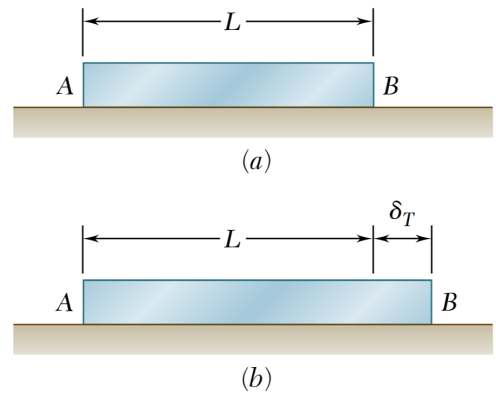
Thermal Expansion

When an unconstrained member is heated, it expands by a length δ_T that is given by the coefficient of thermal expansion α and the change in temperature ΔT .

$$\delta_T = \alpha(\Delta T)L$$

The thermal strain is then

$$\varepsilon_T = \frac{\delta_T}{L} = \alpha \Delta T$$



Thermal Stress

To determine the thermal stress in a **constrained member**, we use a superposition approach similar to the mechanics of prestressed concrete. The process is modeled in two stages:

1. Free Expansion: The member is imagined to undergo unconstrained thermal expansion

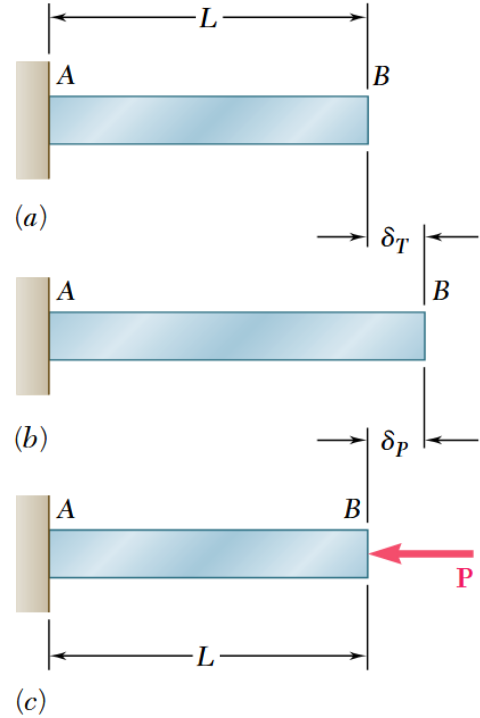
$$\delta_T = \alpha(\Delta T)L$$

2. Constraint Application: A compressive load P is then applied to provide a mechanical displacement δ_P that restores the member to its original length.

$$\delta_P = -\frac{PL}{EA}$$

Since the net displacement in a fixed, constrained structure is zero, we have the constraint

$$\delta = \delta_T + \delta_P = 0$$



Applying the constraint to solve for the induced force:

$$\alpha(\Delta T)L = \frac{PL}{EA} \implies P = \alpha(\Delta T)EA$$

The resulting stress from this restorative load corresponds to the thermal stress in the member:

$$\sigma_T = \frac{-P}{A} = -\alpha(\Delta T)E$$

Sign convention: For a positive change in temperature (heating), the thermal stress is compressive (negative) while for a negative change in temperature (cooling), the thermal stress is tensile (positive).

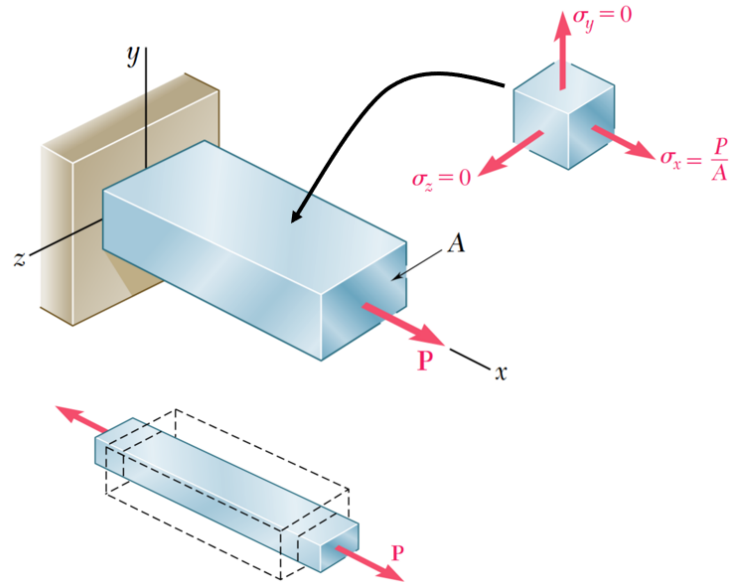
Poisson's Ratio

When a member is stretched in one direction, it causes **transverse shrinkage** in most materials. This is quantified by Poisson's ratio ν . In the case of *uniaxial* stress:

$$\sigma_x = \frac{P}{A}, \quad \sigma_y = \sigma_z = 0$$

$$\varepsilon_x = \frac{P}{EA}$$

$$\varepsilon_y = \varepsilon_z = -\nu\varepsilon_x$$



Saint-Venant's Principle

So far, we have considered only *uniform* stress and strain or calculated the *average* values. In reality, point loads and geometric discontinuities (holes, notches, etc.) produce non-uniform stress and strain distributions.

Saint-Venant's principle identifies the regions where the average stress and strain assumptions hold and states that the influence of these *stress concentrators* can be expressed as the average stress or strain multiplied by a certain factor.

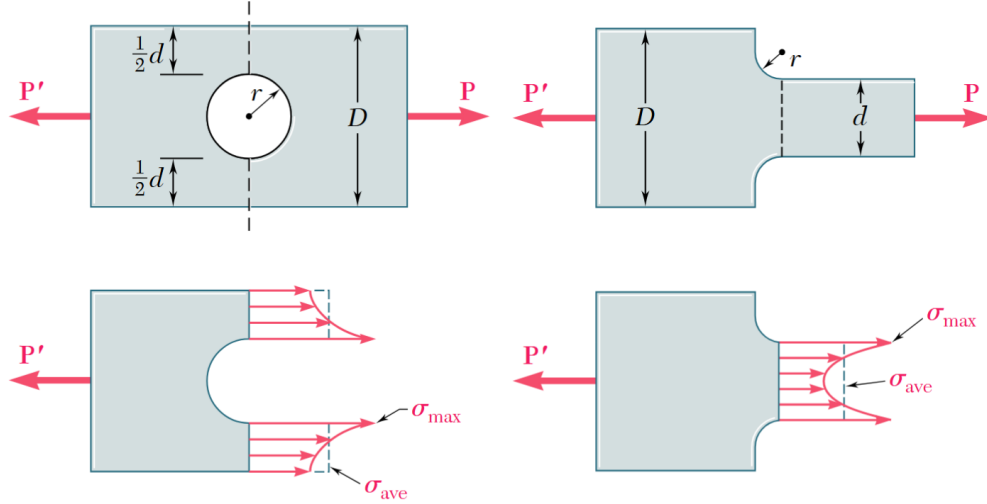
Specifically, in the region beyond 1 member width away from the point of load application or geometric discontinuity, the average stress and strain assumptions hold (within 3%). Only if the member is in static equilibrium.

Stress Concentrations

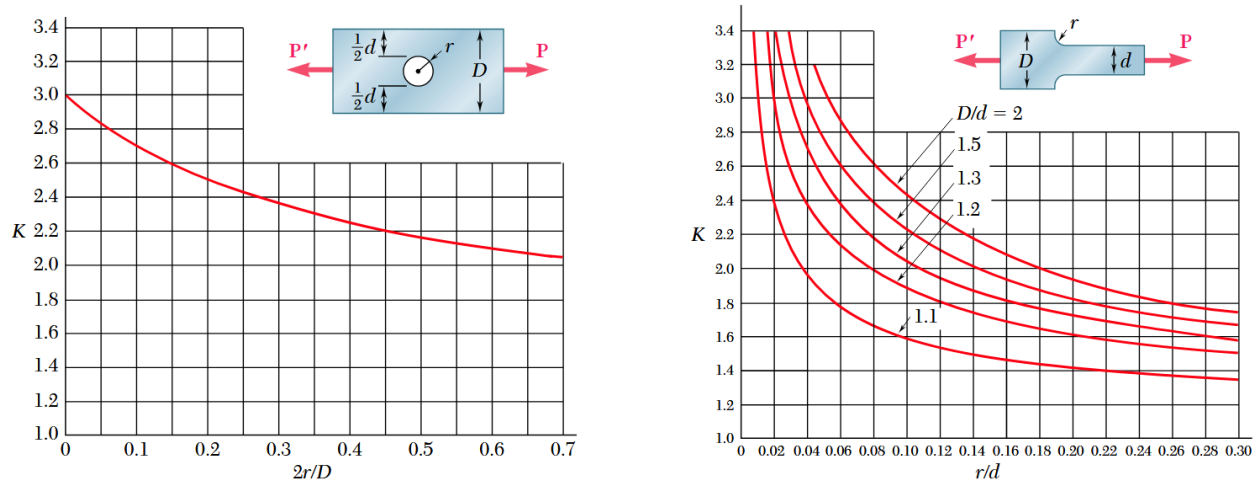
We can quantify the effect of stress concentrators using a *stress concentration factor* K . The stress concentration factor is strictly a function of geometry and load configuration where σ_{ave} is the local average normal stress at the critical area.

$$K = \frac{\sigma_{\text{max}}}{\sigma_{\text{ave}}}$$

For example, near holes and fillets we have the following stress distributions



We determine the stress concentration factor K from tables and then use it to find the maximum stress at the critical area.



Note that the values of K are valid only for the elastic region where $\sigma_{\max} < \sigma_{\text{yield}}$, and they are not valid for plastic deformation where the stress distribution is more uniform.

Plastic Deformation

When $\sigma_{\max} > \sigma_{\text{yield}}$, we use the **bilinear elastoplastic material model**. This means that once the material reaches the yield stress, it begins to deform plastically. In the ideal elastoplastic model, the stress remains *constant* at the yield value while the strain continues to increase until failure.

If the load is removed while the material is in the plastic region, the unloading path follows a linear slope equal to the elastic modulus (E). The stress returns to zero along this line, but a permanent plastic strain remains.

- $\sigma < \sigma_{\text{yield}}$ (elastic region):

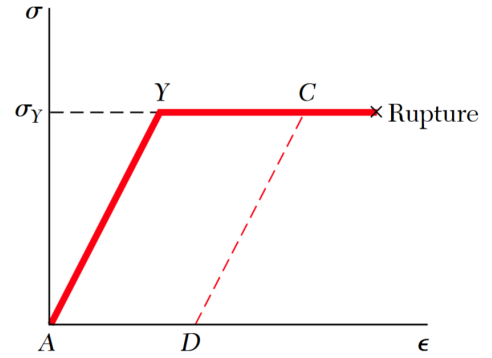
$$\sigma = E\varepsilon$$

- $\sigma \geq \sigma_{\text{yield}}$ (plastic region):

$$\sigma = \sigma_{\text{yield}} \quad (\text{increasing } \varepsilon)$$

- Unloading from plastic region:

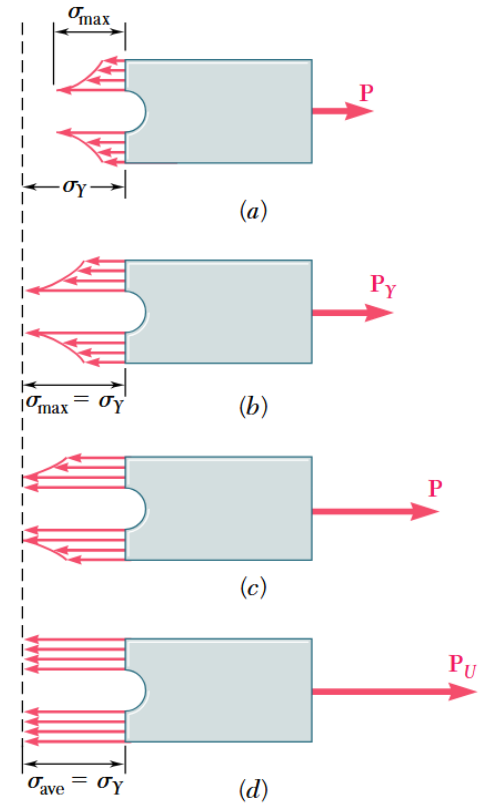
$$\sigma = \sigma_{\text{yield}} - E(\varepsilon_{\text{max}} - \varepsilon) \quad (\text{decreasing } \varepsilon)$$



The stress distribution doesn't actually change in the plastic region, but it is offset more and more as the load increases (to maintain static equilibrium, the area under the curve must equal the applied load).

Under the bilinear elastoplastic material model, the stress cannot exceed the yield stress. So, as more of the cross-section yields, the stress distribution becomes increasingly uniform, approaching a fully plastic state. The maximum load therefore corresponds to the case in which the entire cross-section has reached the yield stress.

$$P_{\text{max}} = \sigma_{\text{yield}} A_{\text{min}}$$



Multiaxial *axial* Loading

In the generalized case where there are multiple axial loads in the x , y , and z directions, we can define the strain in each direction as:

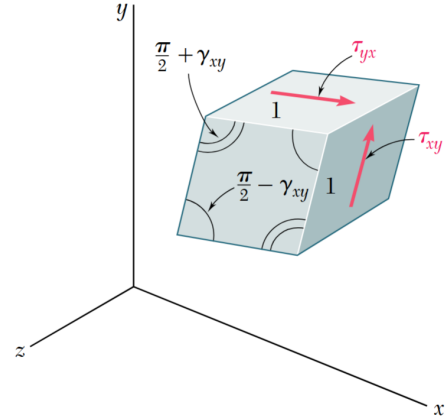
$$\begin{aligned}\varepsilon_x &= \frac{\sigma_x}{E} - \left(\frac{\nu\sigma_y}{E} + \frac{\nu\sigma_z}{E} \right) \\ \varepsilon_y &= \frac{\sigma_y}{E} - \left(\frac{\nu\sigma_x}{E} + \frac{\nu\sigma_z}{E} \right) \\ \varepsilon_z &= \frac{\sigma_z}{E} - \left(\frac{\nu\sigma_x}{E} + \frac{\nu\sigma_y}{E} \right)\end{aligned}$$

The strain in each direction is the sum of the direct strain from the normal stress in that direction and Poisson's effect in the other two transverse directions.

Shear Stress and Strain

If a loading isn't purely axial, then we also have shear stress parallel to the surface. These shear stresses cause a deformation, called shear strain γ , which is an angular deformation in radians that describes how a cube of material shears into a parallelogram. The shear strain is related to the shear stress by the **shear modulus** or **modulus of rigidity** G .

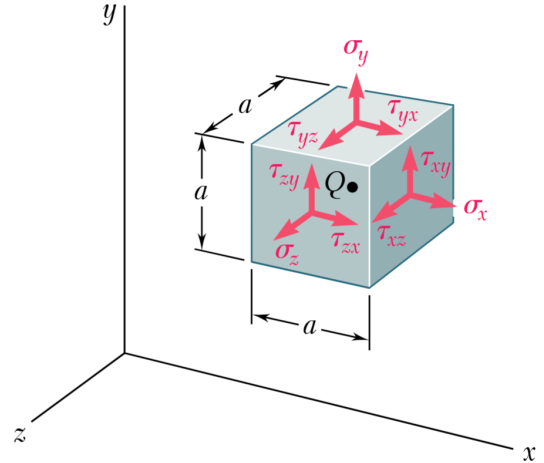
$$\tau_{ij} = G\gamma_{ij}$$



General Stress Strain Relations

Putting together the normal and shear stress-strain relations, we can express the general stress-strain relations in matrix form as normal stress strain describes the material changing size while shear stress strain describes the material changing shape (tilting of the cube).

$$\begin{aligned}\varepsilon_x &= +\frac{\sigma_x}{E} - \frac{\nu\sigma_y}{E} - \frac{\nu\sigma_z}{E} \\ \varepsilon_y &= -\frac{\nu\sigma_x}{E} + \frac{\sigma_y}{E} - \frac{\nu\sigma_z}{E} \\ \varepsilon_z &= -\frac{\nu\sigma_x}{E} - \frac{\nu\sigma_y}{E} + \frac{\sigma_z}{E} \\ \gamma_{xy} &= \frac{\tau_{xy}}{G} \\ \gamma_{xz} &= \frac{\tau_{xz}}{G} \\ \gamma_{yz} &= \frac{\tau_{yz}}{G}\end{aligned}$$



$$\begin{bmatrix} \varepsilon_x \\ \varepsilon_y \\ \varepsilon_z \\ \gamma_{xy} \\ \gamma_{xz} \\ \gamma_{yz} \end{bmatrix} = \frac{1}{E} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -\nu & -\nu & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ -\nu & 1 & -\nu & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ -\nu & -\nu & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & \frac{E}{G} & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & \frac{E}{G} & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & \frac{E}{G} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \sigma_x \\ \sigma_y \\ \sigma_z \\ \tau_{xy} \\ \tau_{xz} \\ \tau_{yz} \end{bmatrix}$$

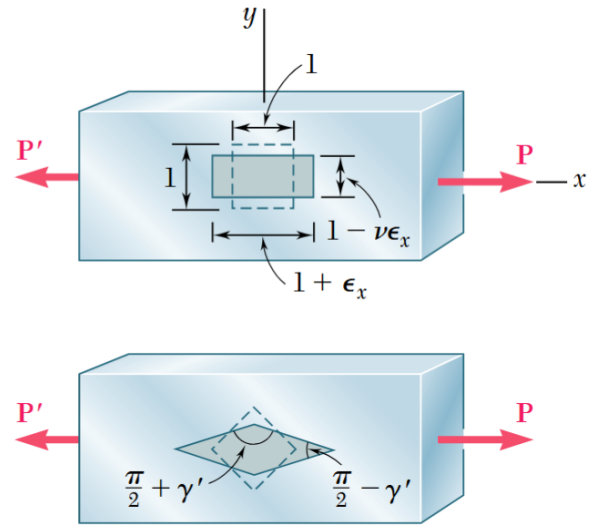
Note: These relationships are only valid for homogeneous, isotropic, linear elastic materials. Which means that the material properties are the same in all directions and the stress-strain relationship is linear (Hooke's law holds).

Normal and Shear Strains

Since the normal and shear stress change with the orientation of the cross-section, we can relate E , G , and ν using the following relation:

$$\nu = \frac{E}{2G} - 1$$

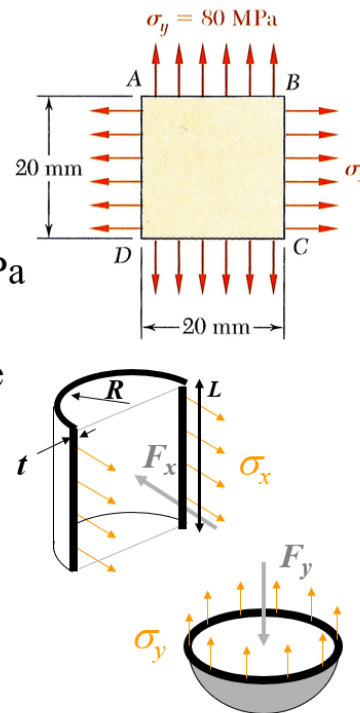
- Young's Modulus (E): [Pa] or [N/m²]
- Shear Modulus (G): [Pa] or [N/m²]
- Poisson's Ratio (ν): dimensionless



Pressure Vessels

Example P 2.67

- State of Stress of pressure vessel wall given $\sigma_y=80\text{MPa}$, $\sigma_x=160\text{MPa}$
- Goal: Find % length change of diagonal line across 20mm square
- Discussion on pressure vessels
- Approach
 - Direct computation of ϵ_x and ϵ_y
 - Geometry calculation



The pressure P inside the vessel will push outwards on the sides and ends, creating the forces F_x and F_y . We can relate these forces to the **hoop stress** σ_x and **axial stress** σ_y using force balances:

$$\sum F_x = 0 = -P(L2R) + \sigma_x(2tL) \quad \Rightarrow \quad \sigma_x = \frac{PR}{t}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\sum F_y = 0 &= -P(\pi R^2) + \sigma_y(\pi R t) \quad \implies \sigma_y = \frac{PR}{2t} \\ &\implies \sigma_x = 2\sigma_y\end{aligned}$$

These normal stresses are redrawn onto the rectangle of material (if we unrolled the side of the vessel). If given Poisson's ratio and the modulus of elasticity, we can find the strains in the x and y directions using the general stress-strain relations.

$$\begin{aligned}\varepsilon_x &= \frac{\sigma_x}{E} - \frac{\nu\sigma_y}{E} \\ \varepsilon_y &= -\frac{\nu\sigma_x}{E} + \frac{\sigma_y}{E}\end{aligned}$$

Thus, the change in the diagonal will just be geometry:

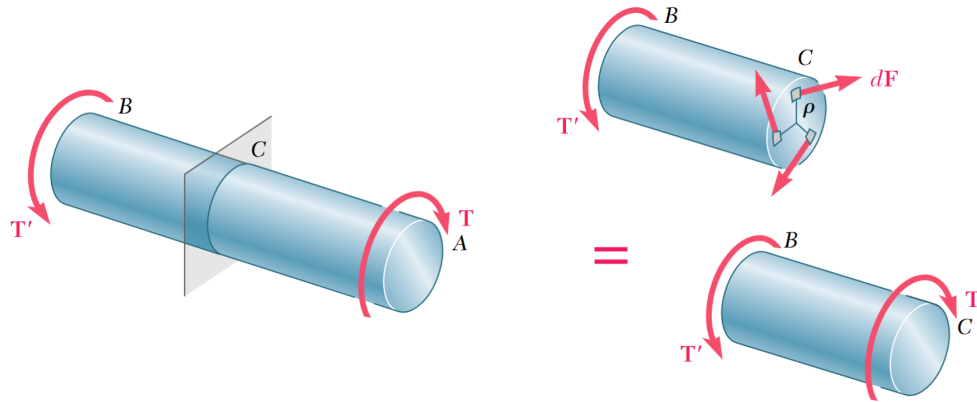
$$L_{x'} = L + L\varepsilon_x \quad (\text{changed length})$$

$$L_{y'} = L + L\varepsilon_y \quad (\text{changed length})$$

- **Original Diagonal (L_0):** Calculated using the Pythagorean theorem: $\sqrt{20^2 + 20^2}$.
- **Deformed Diagonal (L_f):** Calculated using the new side lengths: $\sqrt{(L_{x'})^2 + (L_{y'})^2}$.
- **% Length Change:** Calculated as $\frac{L_f - L_0}{L_0} \times 100$.

Torsion

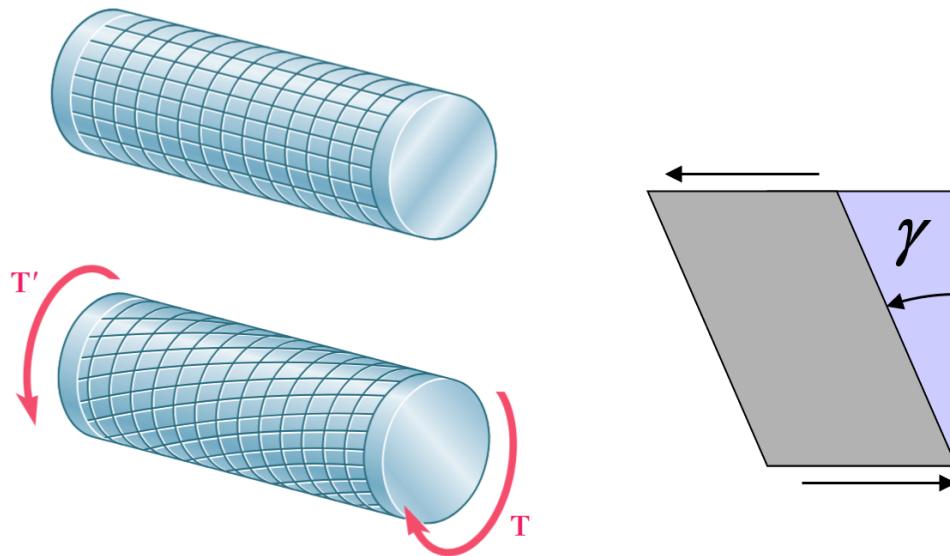
Torque is the result of shear stress. Consider the cross-section of a shaft under torsion, where T' is the internal torque at the cross-section:



Thus, torque can only be transmitted from shear stress in the tangential direction.

Deformation of Axisymmetric Shaft in Torsion

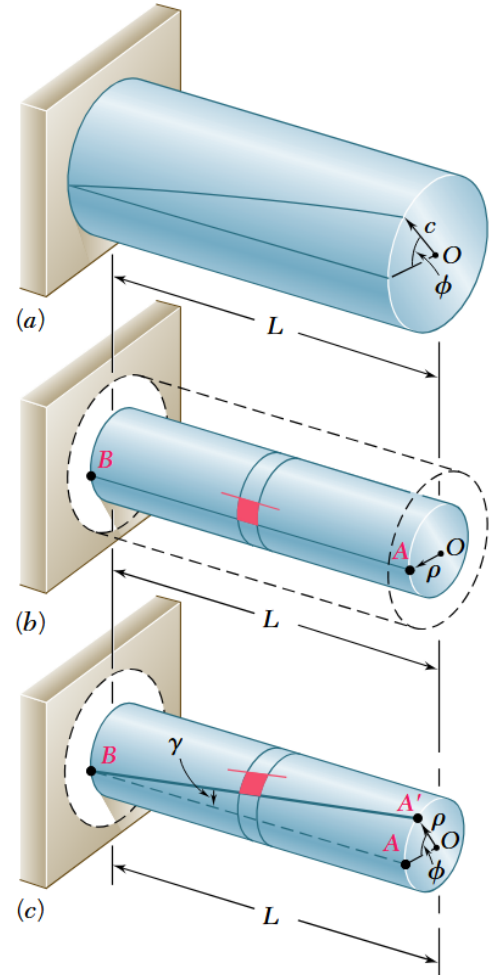
Similar to the intuition of shear strain from before, the cross-section doesn't change size but rather changes shape. Under torsion, the cross-section of the shaft remain the same and the diameter doesn't change but the cross-section twists, and the rectangles become parallelograms.



Twist Angle and Shear Strain

The relationship between the twist angle ϕ and the shear strain γ can be generalized for any radial position ρ in the cross-section (where c is the radius of the cross-section):

$$\gamma = \frac{\rho\phi}{L}$$

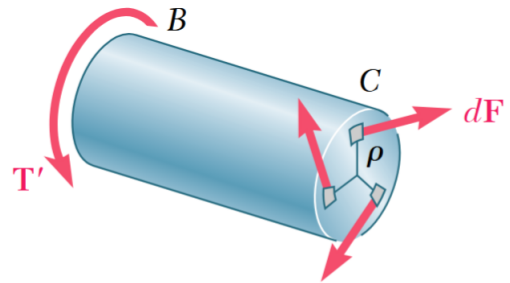


Torque and Twist Angle

Assuming a linear elastic material: $\tau = G\gamma$, we can relate the torque to the twist angle by integrating over the cross-section:

$$\begin{aligned} T &= \int \rho dF_\theta = \int \rho \tau dA = \int \rho G \gamma dA \\ &= \int \rho G \frac{\rho\phi}{L} dA = \frac{G\phi}{L} \underbrace{\int \rho^2 dA}_{\text{Polar moment of inertia } (J)} = \frac{GJ\phi}{L}. \end{aligned}$$

$$T = \frac{GJ\phi}{L}$$



Polar Moment of Inertia

The polar moment of inertia J has units of length⁴ (eg. m^4) and is based on the geometry of the cross-section. For a circular cross-section:

$$J = \int \rho^2 dA = \int_0^c \rho^2 2\pi \rho d\rho = \frac{\pi}{2} c^4$$

$$J = \frac{\pi}{2} c^4 \quad (\text{round shaft})$$

Using superposition, we can find the polar moment of inertia for a hollow circular cross-section by subtracting the inner area from the outer area:

$$J = \frac{\pi}{2} (c_o^4 - c_i^4) \quad (\text{hollow round shaft})$$

Shear Stress Distribution

Rewriting the relationship between shear stress and shear strain, we find that τ is linearly proportional to the radial position ρ . Thus, it is max at the outer radius and zero at the center of the shaft.

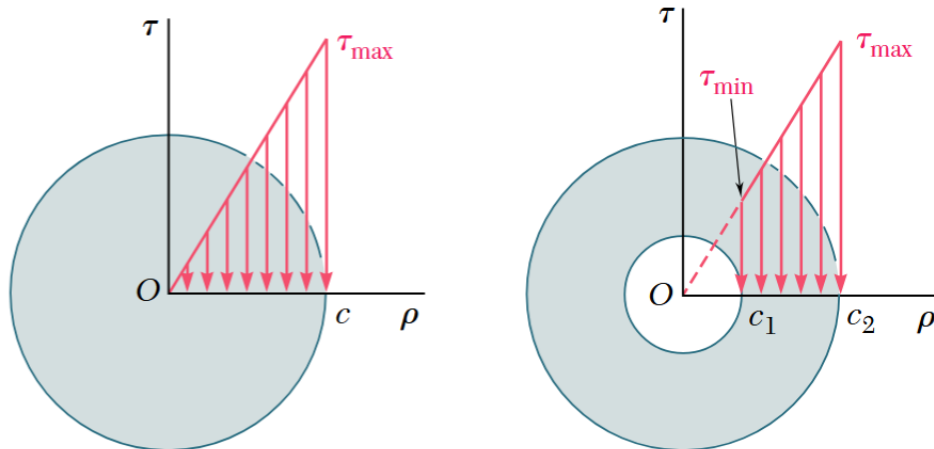
$$\tau = G\gamma = \frac{G\rho\phi}{L}$$

$$\tau_{\max} = \frac{Gc\phi}{L}$$

Relating Torque to Shear Stress

We can rewrite the shear stress formula in terms of torque by:

$$\tau = \frac{T\rho}{J} \implies \tau_{\max} = \frac{Tc}{J}$$



Shaft Stiffness

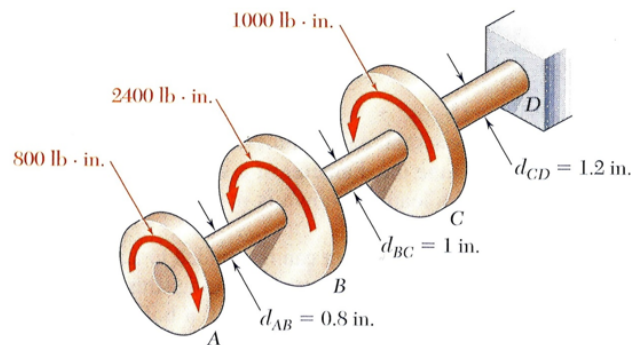
Like axial loading, we can define the stiffness of the shaft as the ratio of the load (torque) to the deformation (twist angle):

$$k_T = \frac{T}{\phi} = \frac{GJ}{L}$$

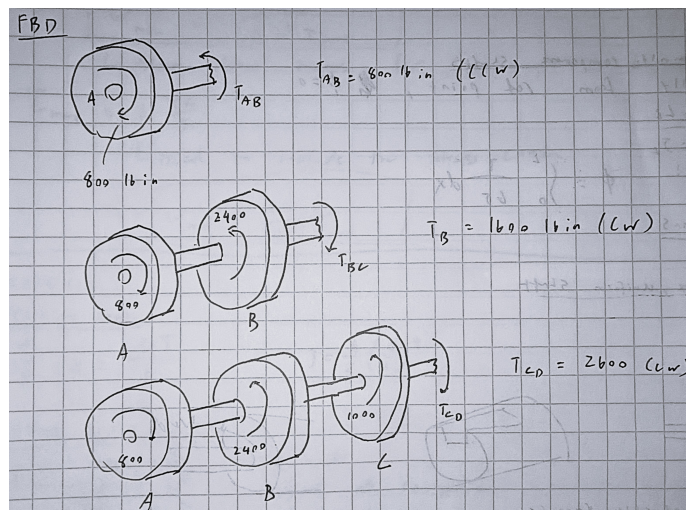
Multiple Torsional Loads

Ex P 3.10

- Hollow shafts (0.4" ID) with torques applied
- Find shaft in which max shear stress occurs
- Find maximum shear stress



Similar to axial deflection before, the torque T is the internal reaction torque at the cross-section, not the applied torque. Thus, we need to first solve for the internal torques using static equilibrium (FBD) and then apply the torsion formulas to find the shear stress and twist angle. (Keep track of direction of the twist angle!)



Total Shaft Twist

We can just sum up the total shaft twist using superposition:

$$\phi = \sum \frac{T_i L_i}{G_i J_i}$$

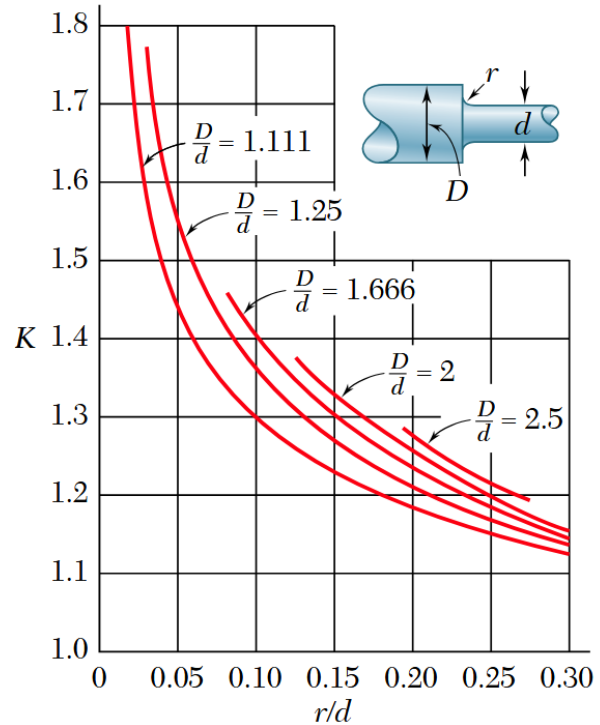
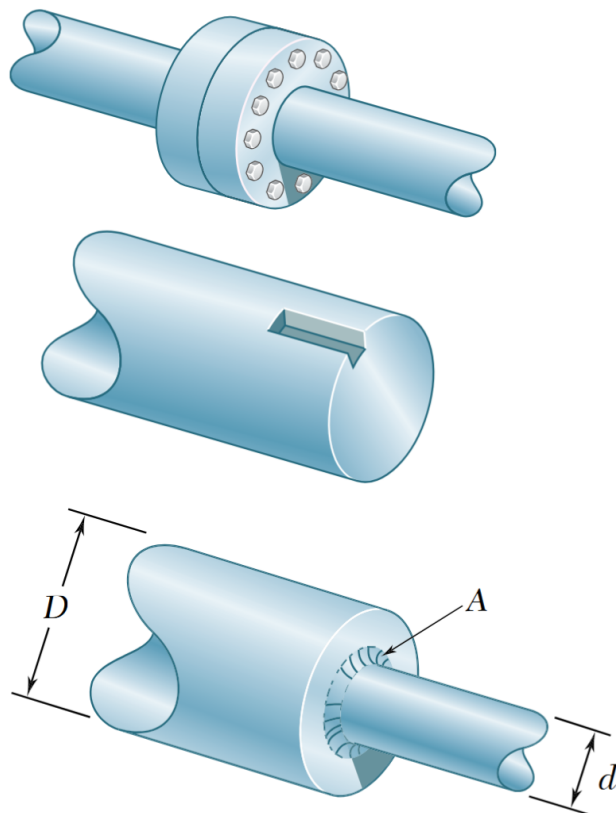
For a continuous shaft, we can integrate over the length of the shaft:

$$\phi = \int_0^L \frac{T}{GJ} dx$$

Stress Concentrations in Circular Shafts

Similar to axial loading, when we have a change in geometry (eg. hole, notch, fillet) or a point load, we have a stress concentration. We use the same stress concentration factor K to relate the max shear stress to the average shear stress at the critical area. Usually, we look at changes in shaft diameter, so the average shear stress is just the shear stress for a uniform shaft with the smaller diameter.

$$\begin{aligned} \tau_{\max} &= K \tau_{\max, \text{uniform shaft}} \\ &= K \frac{Td}{2J}, \quad c = \frac{d}{2} \end{aligned}$$



Shaft Power

Recall that the power transmitted by a rotating shaft is the product of the torque by its rotation rate.

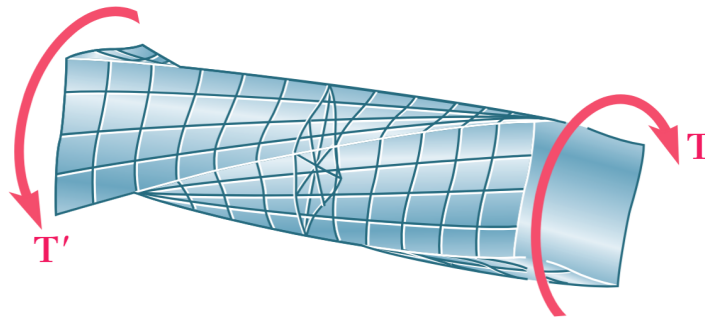
$$\dot{W} = T\omega$$

We will be assuming steady state where the angular velocity ω is constant, so we can still apply principles of static equilibrium to solve for the internal torques and then find the power transmitted by the shaft.

Now we are able to relate rotation to shear stress using power. Note that for a *fixed power*, a smaller angular velocity will require a larger torque, which will lead to a larger shear stress.

Torsion in Non-Circular Members

Lack of symmetry in the cross-section complicates torsion. The cross-sections of non-circular members don't just twist, but also warps. The corners have no shear stress since there's nothing to pull onto it, so it's a less efficient shape than a circular cross-section.



Torsion in Rectangular Bars

The max shear stress occurs on the centerline of the *wide faces* of the bar.

$$\tau_{\max} = \frac{T}{c_1 ab^2}$$

$$\phi = \frac{TL}{c_2 ab^3 G}$$

Where c_1 and c_2 , like the stress concentration factor, are functions of the aspect ratio a/b and can be found in tables. Notice that the thickness b does more to resist torque than the width a .

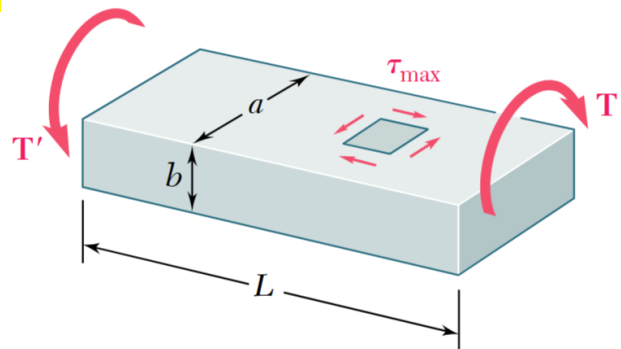
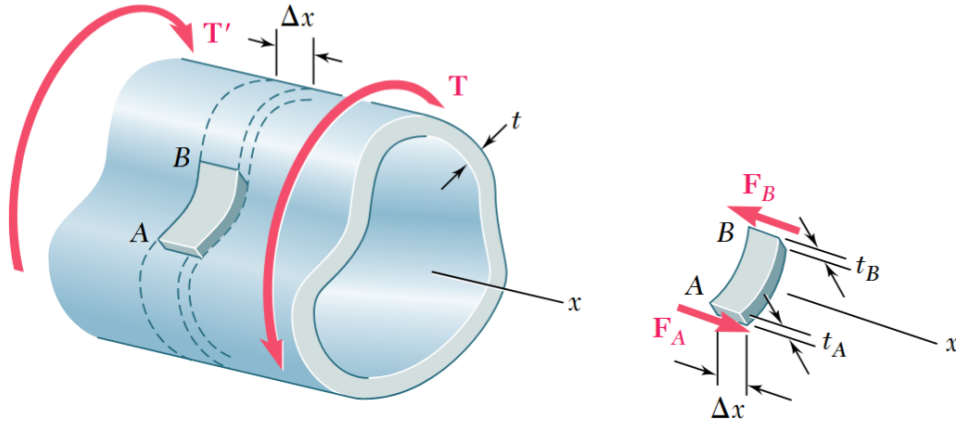


TABLE 3.1. Coefficients for Rectangular Bars in Torsion

a/b	c_1	c_2
1.0	0.208	0.1406
1.2	0.219	0.1661
1.5	0.231	0.1958
2.0	0.246	0.229
2.5	0.258	0.249
3.0	0.267	0.263
4.0	0.282	0.281
5.0	0.291	0.291
10.0	0.312	0.312
∞	0.333	0.333

Thin-Walled Hollow Shafts

Consider the following hollow shaft. Looking along the strip of width $\Delta x \ll$ (thickness), we can see that because the forces F_A and F_B are balanced (due to equilibrium), we can define the shear flow q .



$$F_A = F_B$$

$$\tau_A t_A \Delta x = \tau_B t_B \Delta x \implies \tau_A t_A = \tau_B t_B = \text{constant}$$

Thus, we define this constant as the shear flow q .

$$\boxed{q = \tau t}$$

Finding the Shear Stress in a Hollow Shaft

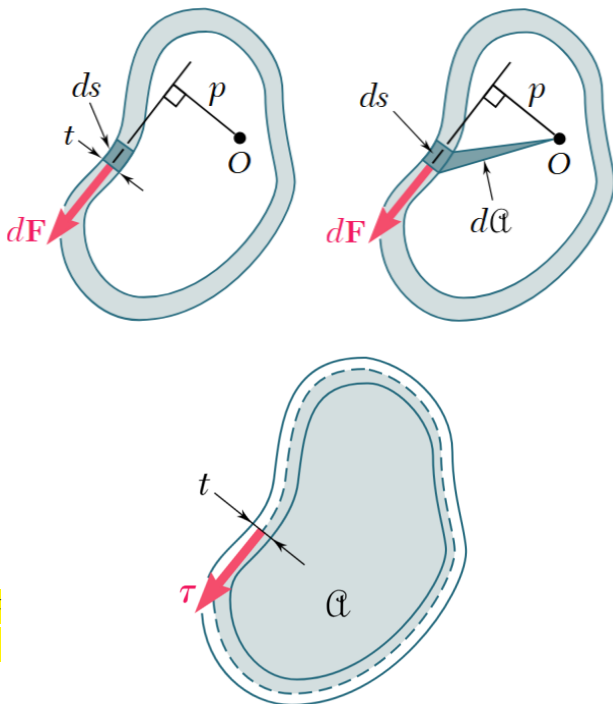
We will use the fact that the shear flow is constant across the cross-section to find the shear stress and twist angle. Like before, we can relate the torque to shear stress by integrating over the cross-section:

$$\begin{aligned} T &= \oint p dF \\ &= \oint p(\tau t ds) \\ &= q \oint 2 da \end{aligned}$$

Notice we expressed the product $p ds$ as twice the area of the shaded triangle da , since the area of any triangle is just $\frac{1}{2} \times \text{base} \times \text{height}$, where the base is ds and the height is p . Thus, we can relate shear stress to torque by:

$$\boxed{\tau = \frac{T}{2ta}}$$

Where a is the area enclosed by the *shaft midline* of the cross-section (the line running in the center of the thickness).



Finding the Twist Angle in a Hollow Shaft

- Find ϕ , given $\tau = \frac{T}{2ta}$
- Approach:
 - Assume linear elastic
 - Work = strain energy (assuming statics)

Strain Energy Density:

$$u \equiv \int_0^\gamma \tau d\gamma = \int_0^\gamma G\gamma d\gamma = \frac{1}{2}G\gamma^2 = \frac{1}{2G}\tau^2$$

Linear Elastic $\implies T = k_T\phi$

Work of Torsion:

$$W = \int_0^\phi T d\phi = \int_0^\phi k_T\phi d\phi = \frac{1}{2}k_T\phi^2 = \boxed{\frac{1}{2}T\phi}$$

Strain Energy:

$$U = \int u dV = \oint \frac{\tau^2}{2G} L t ds = \oint \frac{T^2}{2G4a^2t^2} L t ds = \boxed{\frac{T^2 L}{2G4a^2} \oint \frac{ds}{t}}$$

Work = Elastic Energy in linear elastic shaft:

$$\Rightarrow \frac{1}{2}T\phi = \frac{T^2L}{2G4a^2} \oint \frac{ds}{t}$$

$$\boxed{\phi = T \frac{L}{4Ga^2} \oint \frac{ds}{t}}$$

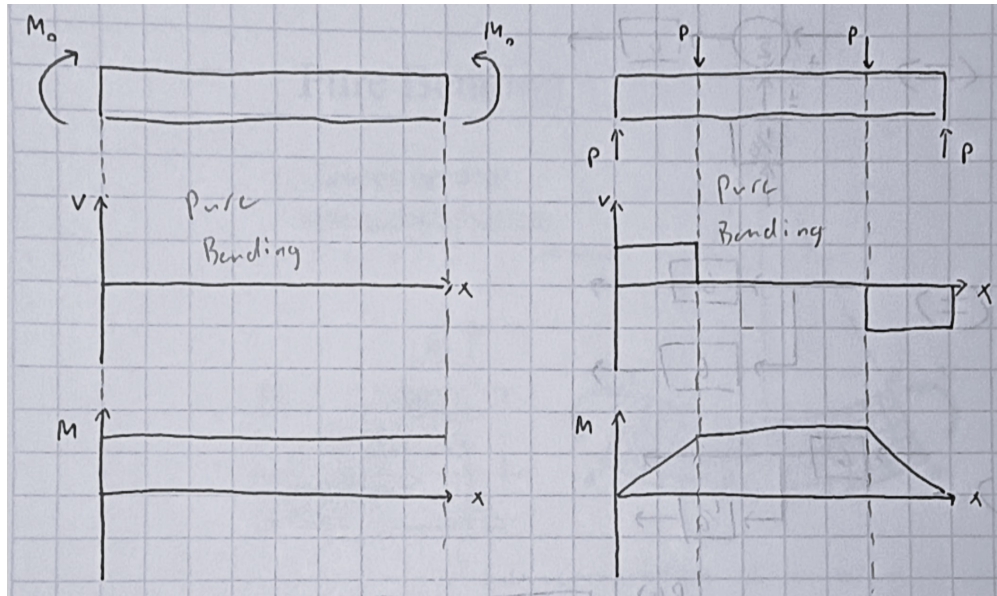
$$T = k_T\phi, \text{ where } k_T \equiv \frac{4Ga^2}{L \oint \frac{ds}{t}}$$

Here, ds refers to the path along the same midline of the shaft as before, and t is the thickness at that point along the path. Keep this in mind when evaluating the integral $\oint \frac{ds}{t}$.

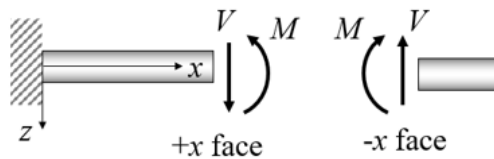
Note: The criteria for thin-walled is that the thickness t is less than $\frac{1}{10}$ of the radius of curvature of the midline. For a circular shaft, this means $t < \frac{1}{10}c$.

Pure Bending

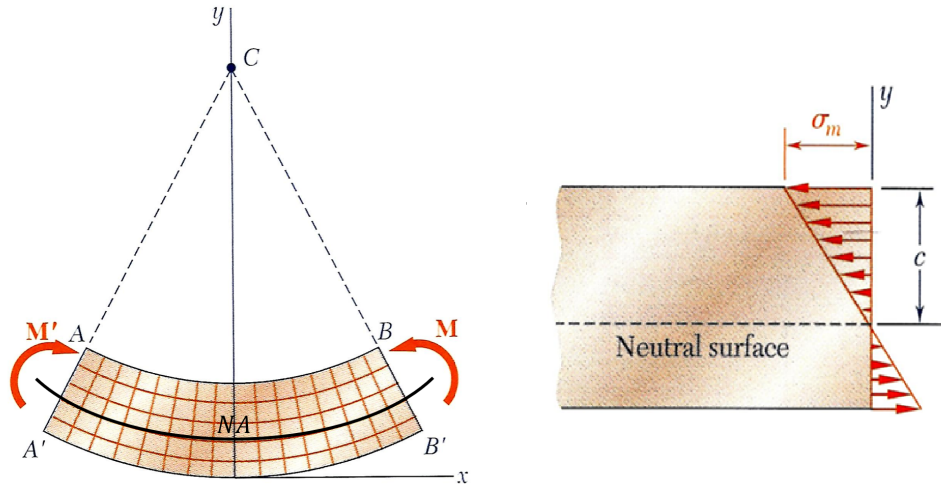
If we apply a load to a beam, it will bend. The simplest case is **pure bending** where there are no internal shear loads, and a *constant* internal bending moment throughout the beam. Where V is the internal shear force and M is the internal bending moment:



Note the sign convention for the positive directions of the internal shear force and bending moment. Generally, a positive internal shear V and bending moment M will tend to bend the beam into an upwards facing U, and result in the lower surface of the beam being in tension. The $+x$ face is seen by taking a cut and keeping the left side of the beam, and vice versa for the $-x$ face.



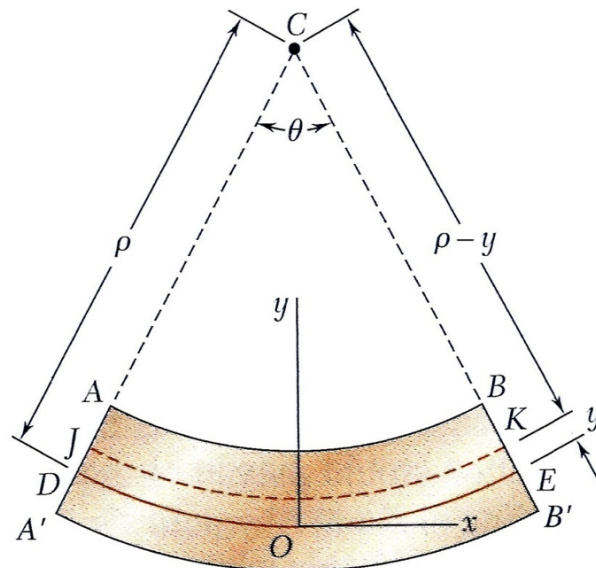
Under pure bending, the beam will deflect into an arc of a circle. If we imagine the beam as a stack of thin fibers, we can see that as the beam deflects, the fibers at the top of the beam will shorten while the fibers at the bottom will lengthen. Thus, the top surface of the beam will be in compression while the bottom surface will be in tension. However, there exists a layer of fibers in between whose length doesn't change and thus has zero stress. This layer is called the **neutral axis** or the **neutral surface** in 3D.



Note that there are only normal stresses in pure bending, and no shear stresses. The normal stress distribution is linear across the cross-section, with the max tensile and compressive stresses at the outer fibers and zero stress at the neutral axis.

Determining the Bending Stress & Strain

Consider a beam of length initial length L under pure bending. Where arc DE is the neutral axis, consider a fiber a distance y from the neutral axis (arc JK). The coordinate system is centered on the neutral axis ($y = 0$ at the neutral axis).



Since the neutral axis doesn't change length, we equate the length of arc DE to the initial length of the beam:

$$L = \rho\theta, \quad \rho \text{ is the radius of curvature}$$

For the fiber at distance y from the neutral axis, the length of arc JK is:

$$s = (\rho + y)\theta$$

By the definition of strain, we find that the normal strain in a beam at a distance y from the neutral axis is:

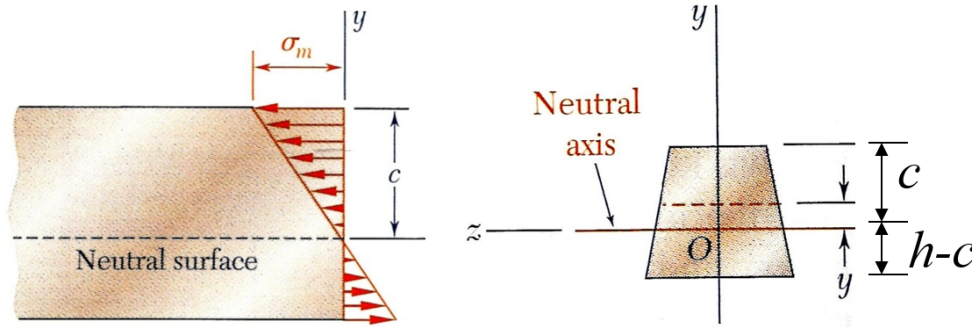
$$\varepsilon_x = \frac{\Delta L}{L} = \frac{\rho\theta - (\rho + y)\theta}{\rho\theta} = -\frac{y\theta}{\rho\theta}$$

$$\boxed{\varepsilon_x = -\frac{y}{\rho}}$$

Assuming that stresses remain in the linear elastic region, we can relate the normal stress to the normal strain using Hooke's law:

$$\boxed{\sigma_x = E\varepsilon_x = -\frac{Ey}{\rho}}$$

Therefore, using the distances of the top and bottom surfaces to the neutral axis, we can find the max tensile and compressive stresses in the beam.



$$\boxed{\sigma_{\text{max,compressive}} = -\frac{Ec}{\rho}, \quad \sigma_{\text{max,tensile}} = \frac{E(h-c)}{\rho}}$$

Note: The positive y -axis points towards the center of curvature!

Location of the Neutral Axis

The neutral axis passes through the centroid of the beam cross-section.

We can show this by considering the force balance on the cross-section. The beam is in static equilibrium, so the net force must be zero.

$$F_x = \int \sigma_x dA = 0$$

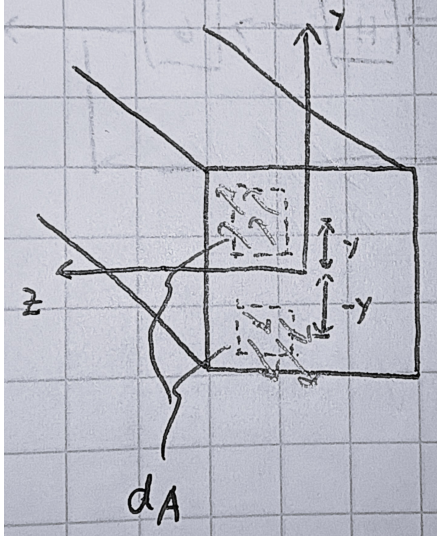
Substituting the bending stress formula, we have:

$$F_x = \int -\frac{Ey}{\rho} dA = 0 \implies \int y dA = 0$$

This says that the *first area moment* of the cross-section is equal to zero. The only way this can be true is if the x-axis (neutral axis) passes through the centroid of the cross-section, since the centroid is the point where the first area moment is zero.

Determining the Bending Moment

We can calculate the bending moment at the cross-section by integrating the moment of the normal stresses about the neutral axis:



$$M_z = \int y \underbrace{(-\sigma_x) dA}_{\text{Force about z}}$$

Substituting the bending stress formula, we have:

$$M_z = \int y \frac{Ey}{\rho} dA = \frac{E}{\rho} \int y^2 dA$$

Thus, letting $I = \int y^2 dA$ be the **second area moment** of the cross-section about the neutral axis (x-axis), we can express the bending moment as:

$$M_z = \frac{EI}{\rho}$$

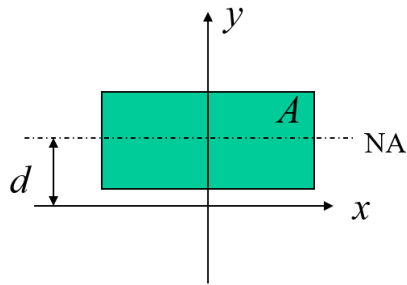
$$\Rightarrow \frac{1}{\rho} = \frac{M}{EI} \quad (\text{curvature})$$

Therefore there is no z dependence on the bending moment, only the cross-sectional geometry (through I) and the material properties (through E) matters.

Additionally, we can now express the bending stress in terms of the bending moment by substituting the bending moment formula into the bending stress formula:

$$\sigma_x = -\frac{My}{I}, \quad \sigma_{m,c} = -\frac{Mc}{I}, \quad \sigma_{m,t} = \frac{M(h-c)}{I}$$

Parallel Axis Theorem



We can relate the second area moment of a cross-section about the neutral axis to the second area moment about any other axis parallel to the neutral axis using the **parallel axis theorem**:

$$I_{xx} = I_{NA} + Ad^2$$

Where I_{NA} is the second area moment about the neutral axis, A is the area of the cross-section, and d is the distance between the two axes.

Composite Cross-Sections

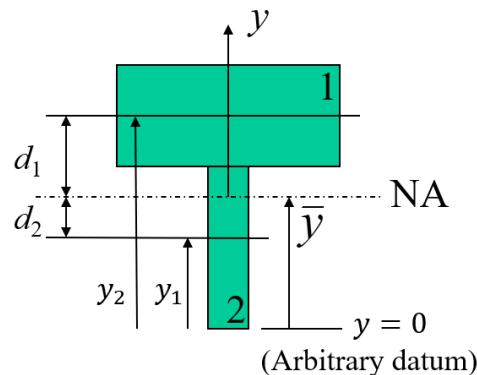
For cross-sections composed of a combination of geometric shapes, we must find I about the *composite* neutral axis. To do so, we will apply the parallel axis theorem, but first we need to locate the neutral axis. Recall that a property of the centroid ($\bar{y}$) is that

$$A\bar{y} = \int y dA$$

Thus, for a composite cross-section, we can find the location of the neutral axis by summing the contributions of each shape:

$$\bar{y} = \frac{\sum A_i \bar{y}_i}{\sum A_i}$$

Where A_i is the area of each shape and $\bar{y}_i$ is the distance from the reference axis to the centroid of each shape.



Now, we can apply the parallel axis theorem to sum up the second area moment of each shape about the composite neutral axis:

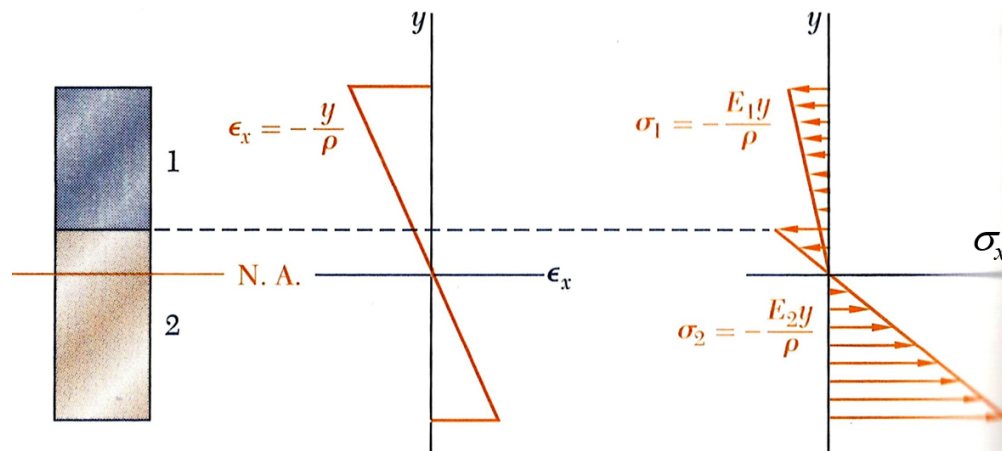
$$I = I_{1,NA} + I_{2,NA} + \cdots + I_{n,NA}$$

Where

$$I_{i,NA} = I_i + A_i d_i^2$$

Members Made of Several Materials

When we have multiple materials, the modulus of elasticity E is different for each material. Additionally, some polymers have varying E depending on if the load is applied in tension or compression where $E_{\text{tension}} < E_{\text{compression}}$. We will assume that strain remains a linear function ($\epsilon = -y/\rho$) across the section, but the stress will be piecewise linear since E is different for each material.



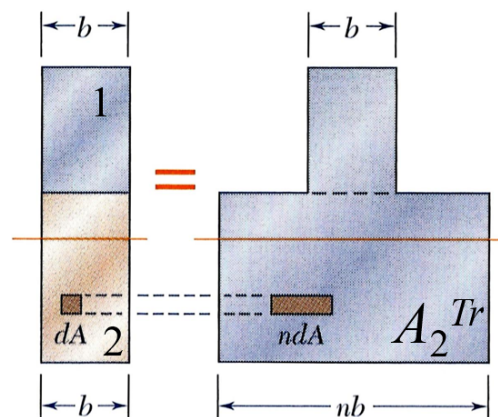
Transformed Section Method

We account for the difference in E by transforming the cross-section of one material into an equivalent cross-section of the other material. Basically, we say that the effect of having a different E for material 2 has the *same effect as making material 1* bigger by a factor of n :

$$n = \frac{E_2}{E_1}$$

In this case, the material with E_1 is called the **reference material**. Thus, the transformed section has:

$$E_2^{Tr} = E_1, \quad A_2^{Tr} = nA_2$$



Actual (Real) Stresses

After finding the normal stresses within the transformed section normally (σ_x^{Tr}), we can find the actual stresses within each material by:

$$\sigma_{x,1} = \sigma_x^{Tr}, \quad \sigma_{x,2} = n\sigma_x^{Tr}$$

Because material 1 is the reference material, the calculated stress in the transformed section is the same as the actual stress in material 1. However, since material 2 has a different E , we need to multiply the calculated stress in the transformed section by n to get the actual stress in material 2.

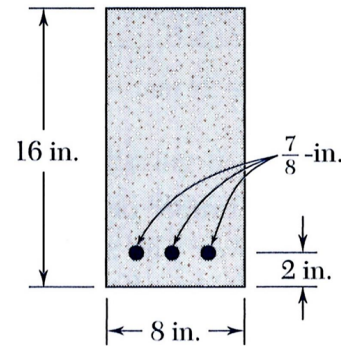
The radius of curvature can be found in terms of only the transformed section properties:

$$\frac{1}{\rho} = \frac{M}{E^{Tr} I^{Tr}}$$

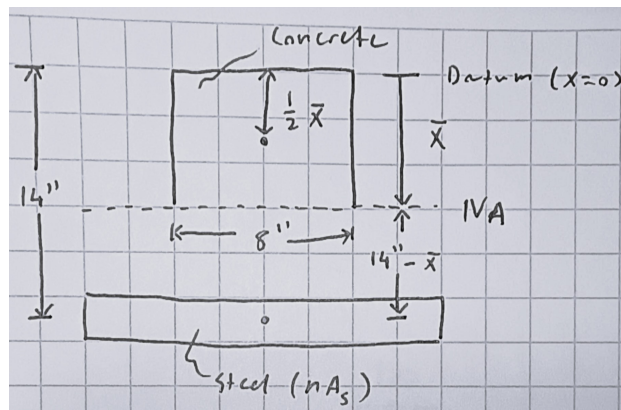
Reinforced Concrete Beam

Example – Reinforced Concrete Beam, p4.49

- Find maximum moment M .
 $\sigma_{all} = 1.35\text{ksi}$ (concrete),
 $\sigma_{all} = 20\text{ksi}$ (steel)



First we will assume that concrete *only bears compressive load*. We show this by not considering the region of concrete in tension (below the neutral axis) in our calculations. Second, we will use the transformed section method with concrete as the reference materials (since $E_{concrete} < E_{steel}$, we will be making the steel bigger in the transformed section).



Approach:

- Use a transformed section for the steel with concrete as the reference material

$$n = \frac{E_s}{E_c}, \quad A_s^{Tr} = nA_s$$

- Locate the neutral axis relative to the arbitrary datum using the equation

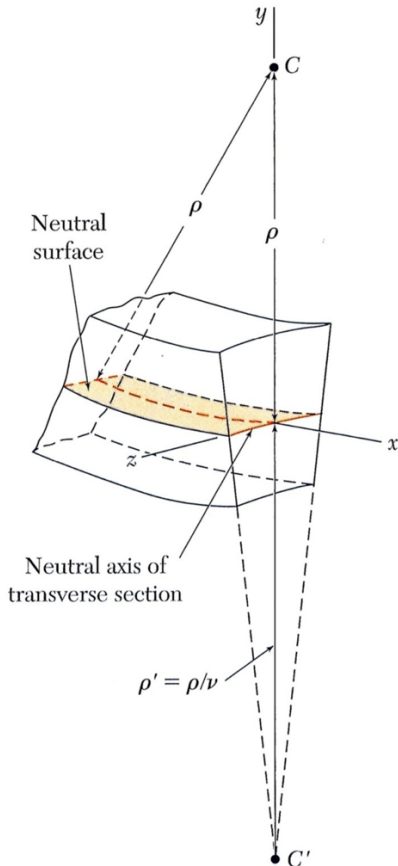
$$\bar{x} = \frac{\sum A_i \bar{x}_i}{\sum A_i}$$

- Relate the max allowable stress to the critical moments in each material. Since concrete is the reference material, it doesn't need to be rescaled by n .

$$\sigma_c = -\frac{My}{I^{Tr}} \Rightarrow \sigma_{\max,c} = \sigma_{\text{all},c} = -\frac{M_{\max,c} \bar{x}}{I^{Tr}} \quad (\text{compressive})$$

$$\sigma_s = n \frac{My}{I^{Tr}} \Rightarrow \sigma_{\max,s} = \sigma_{\text{all},s} = n \frac{M_{\max,s} (14 - \bar{x})}{I^{Tr}} \quad (\text{tensile})$$

Deformation of Beam Cross-Section



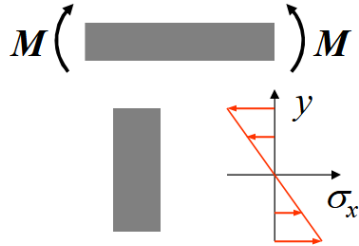
$$\varepsilon_y = -\nu \varepsilon_x = -\nu \frac{y}{\rho} = \varepsilon_z$$

Thus, the cross-section of the can be described as an **anticlastic curvature** where the cross-section curves in the opposite direction of the bending curvature.

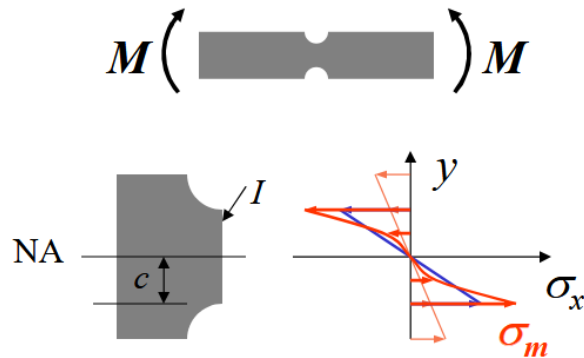
$$\frac{1}{\rho'} = \frac{\nu}{\rho}$$

Stress Concentrations in Bending

Stress concentrations can also occur in bending, which are caused by changes in the beam cross-section. In a uniform beam, the bending stress is uniform and linear across the cross-section.

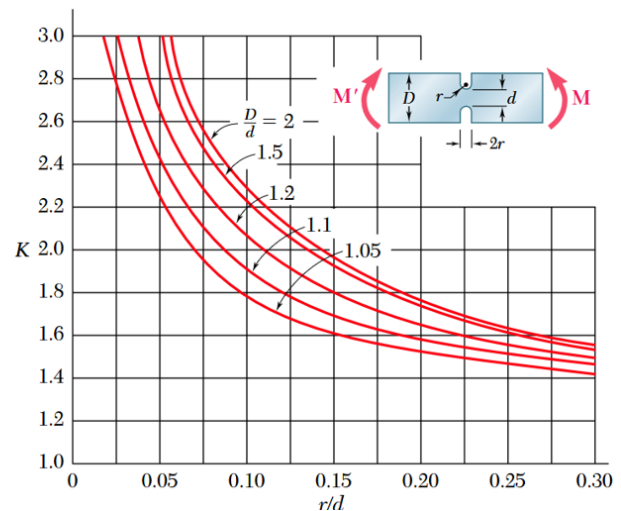
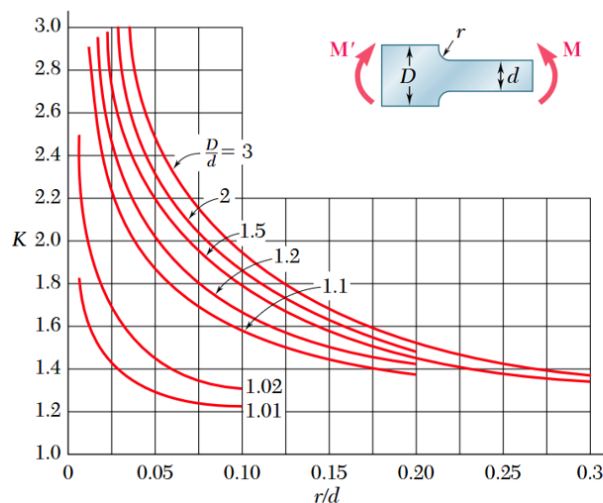


For a non-uniform beam, we can assume that the normal stress is increased by a factor of K at the critical area (shown by the blue linear stress distribution). In reality, the stress distribution is non-linear.



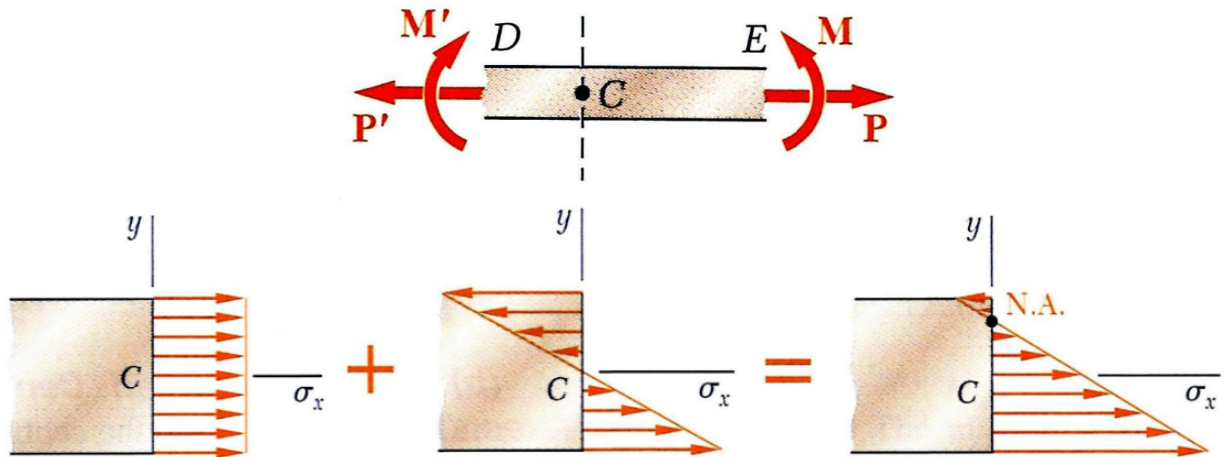
Using the dimensions (c) and properties (I) of the critical region, we define the local max bending stress as:

$$\sigma_{\max} = K \frac{Mc}{I}$$



Bending with Axial Loads

Suppose in addition to the bending moment, we also have an axial load P applied to the beam. Since we are assuming linear elastic behavior, we can use superposition to find the total stress at any point in the beam.

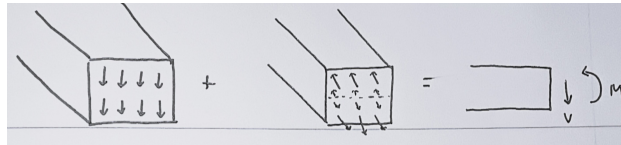


The axial load will create a uniform normal stress across the cross-section, while the bending moment will create a linear normal stress distribution. Thus, the total normal stress at any point along the cross-section is:

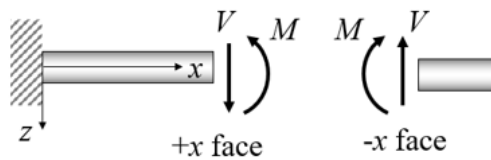
$$\sigma_x = \sigma_{x,\text{axial}} + \sigma_{x,\text{bending}} = \frac{P}{A} - \frac{My}{I}$$

Beam Design for Bending

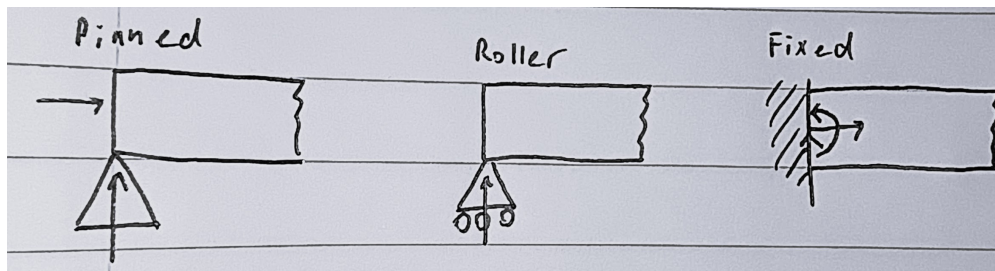
So far, we have only analyzed pure bending, where no shear forces are present. When a beam is subjected to shear forces, the bending moment is no longer constant along the length of the beam. As a result, the beam experiences both normal stresses due to bending and shear stresses due to shear. The resultants of these internal stresses correspond to the internal shear force (V), and bending moment (M).



Sign convention: As mentioned before, the positive sign convention for V and M depends both on the direction of the internal forces and which side of the beam is being considered.



Types of Supports

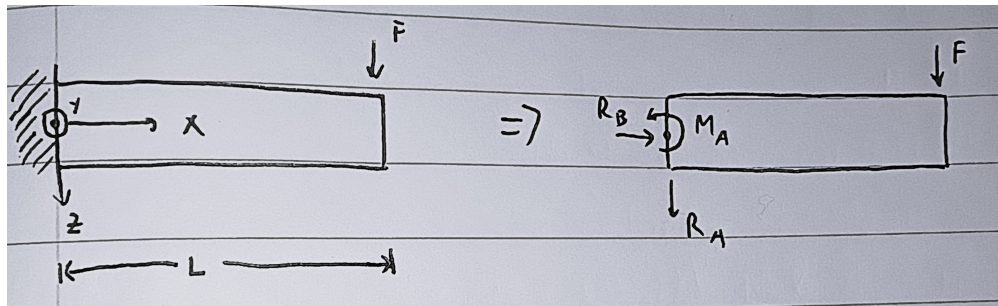


Shear and Moment Distribution

Point Loads

To determine the shear and moment distribution along the length of the beam we can use the following approach:

1. Draw a free body diagram of the entire beam, showing all external loads and reactions. Use static equilibrium to solve for the unknown reactions at the supports.



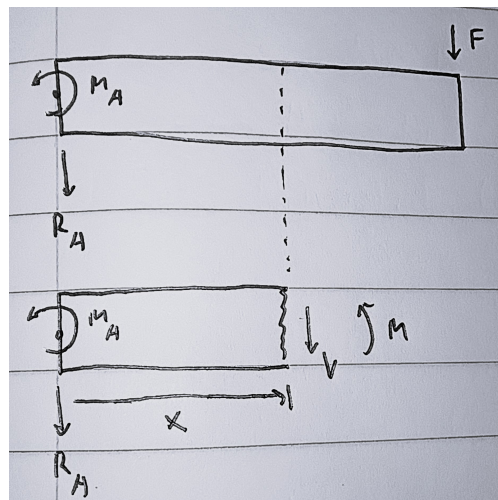
2. Solve for external reactions if statically determinate (3 static equilibrium equations for 3 unknowns). If statically indeterminate, use superposition.

$$\sum F_x = R_B = 0$$

$$\sum F_z = R_A + F = 0 \implies R_A = -F$$

$$\sum M_y = M_A - FL = 0 \implies M_A = FL$$

3. Make cuts along the length of the beam in between external applied loads. Use static equilibrium on these sections to solve for the internal shear force and bending moment at each cut.

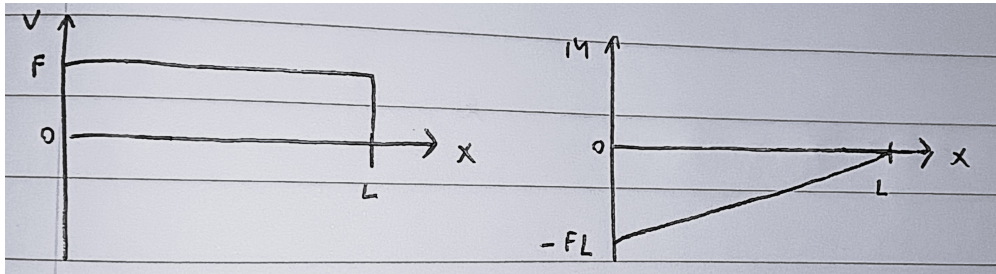


4. Solve for the internal shear force and bending moment at each cut using static equilibrium.

$$\sum F_z = R_A + V = 0 \implies -F + V = 0 \implies V = F$$

$$\sum M_y = M_A + M - Vx = 0 \implies FL + M - Fx = 0 \implies M = -FL + Fx$$

5. Draw the shear force and bending moment distributions.



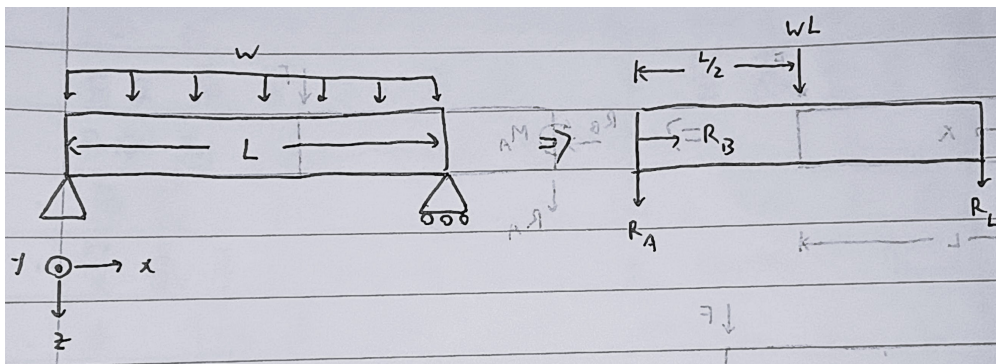
Distributed Loading

For distributed loading, we can use the same approach for point loads, however, the load is now a **force per unit length (w)**. Thus, the internal shear force will vary along the length of the beam.

If we think of the load distribution (w) as a geometric shape, then its line of action is through the **centroid** of the shape. Thus, we can replace the distributed load with a single equivalent point load acting at the centroid of the shape.

For example:

1. Beam FBD and solve for reactions:

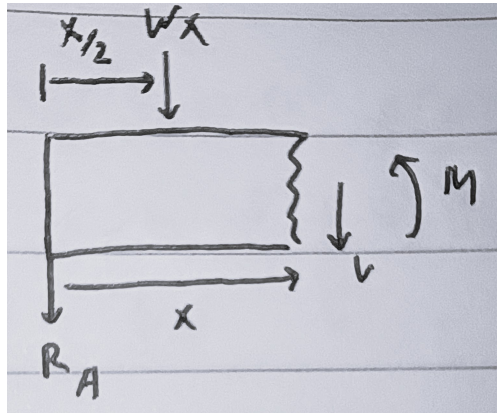


$$\sum F_x = R_B = 0$$

$$\sum F_z = R_A + wL + R_L = 0$$

$$\sum M_{y,A} = -wL \left(\frac{L}{2} \right) - R_L L = 0 \implies R_L = -\frac{1}{2}wL \implies R_A = -\frac{1}{2}wL$$

2. Beam section FBD:



$$\sum F_x = 0$$

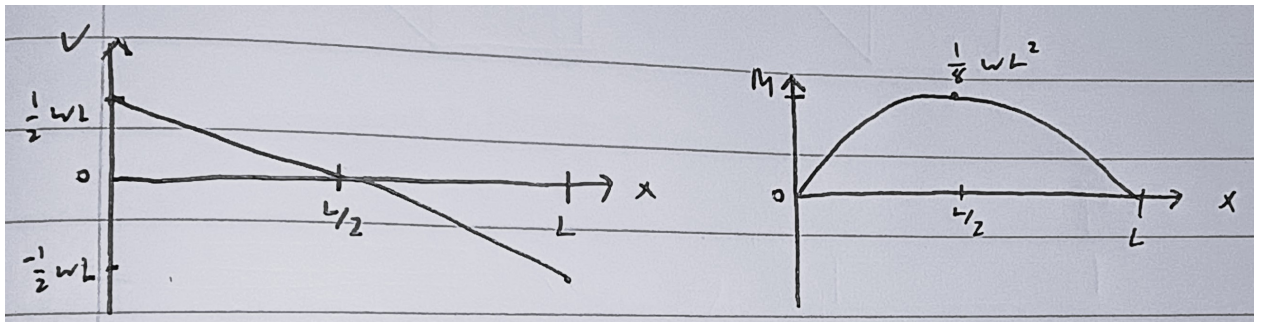
$$\sum F_z = R_A + wx + V = 0 \implies -\frac{1}{2}wL + wx + V = 0 \implies V = \frac{1}{2}wL - wx$$

$$\sum M_{y,A} = -wx \left(\frac{x}{2} \right) - Vx + M = 0 \implies -\frac{1}{2}wx^2 - Vx + M = 0$$

$$\implies M = \frac{1}{2}wx^2 + Vx$$

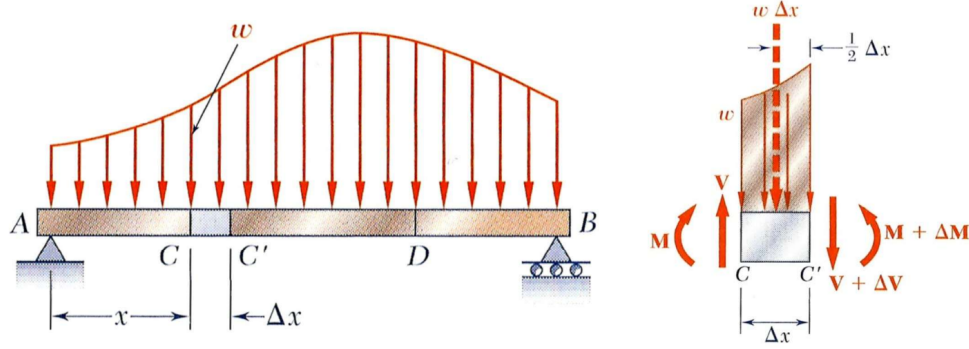
$$\implies M = \frac{wx}{2} (L - x)$$

3. V and M distributions:



Differential Equation Method for Deriving Shear and Moment Distributions

Instead of using multiple static equilibrium analyses to find the shear and moment distributions, we can use a differential equation approach. We derive the differential equations by considering a small section of a beam under distributed loading.



$$\text{Shear-Load Relation: } \frac{dV}{dx} = -w$$

$$\text{Shear-Moment Relation: } \frac{dM}{dx} = V$$

We can solve these differential equations by integrating from the left end of the beam ($x = 0$) to a point x along the beam. The constants of integration can be found by applying the boundary conditions at the left end of the beam (reaction forces and moments).

Note: Stay consistent with the $+x$ face sign convention for V and M when applying the boundary conditions.

Beam Design for Strength

Designing a beam for strength means determining the dimensions of the beam cross-section such that the max bending stress does not exceed the allowable stress of the material.

$$\sigma_{\max} \leq \sigma_{\text{all}}$$

From the elastic flexure formula, the max tensile and compressive stresses occur at the outer fibers of the beam cross-section.

$$\sigma_{\max} = \frac{|M|_{\max} c}{I}$$

For convenience, we can define the **section modulus** S to describe all geometry properties of the cross-section:

$$S = \frac{I}{c}$$

Where c is the max distance from the neutral axis to the outer fiber of the cross-section. Thus, to meet the allowable stress requirement, we can design the beam cross-section such that:

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_{\text{all}} &\geq \sigma_{\max} = \frac{Mc}{I} = \frac{M}{S} \\ \Rightarrow S &\geq \frac{M_{\max}}{\sigma_{\text{all}}} \end{aligned}$$

Prismic Beams

A prismic beam is a beam with a constant cross-section along its length. Thus, it has a uniform section modulus S along its length. To design a prismic beam, we then only need to find where the bending moment is max (usually where shear is zero) and use that to determine the required section modulus.

Non-Prismic Beams

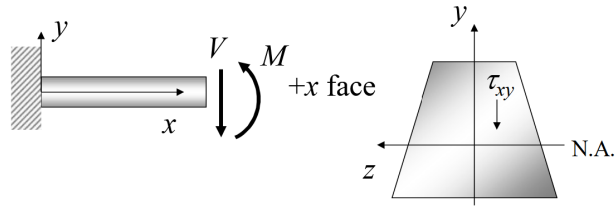
To optimize for material and weight, we can design a non-prismic beam with a varying cross-section along its length. Thus, the most efficient design would meet the following condition for every section:

$$\begin{aligned}\sigma_{\max} &= \sigma_{\text{all}} \\ \implies S(x) &= \frac{|M(x)|}{\sigma_{\text{all}}}\end{aligned}$$

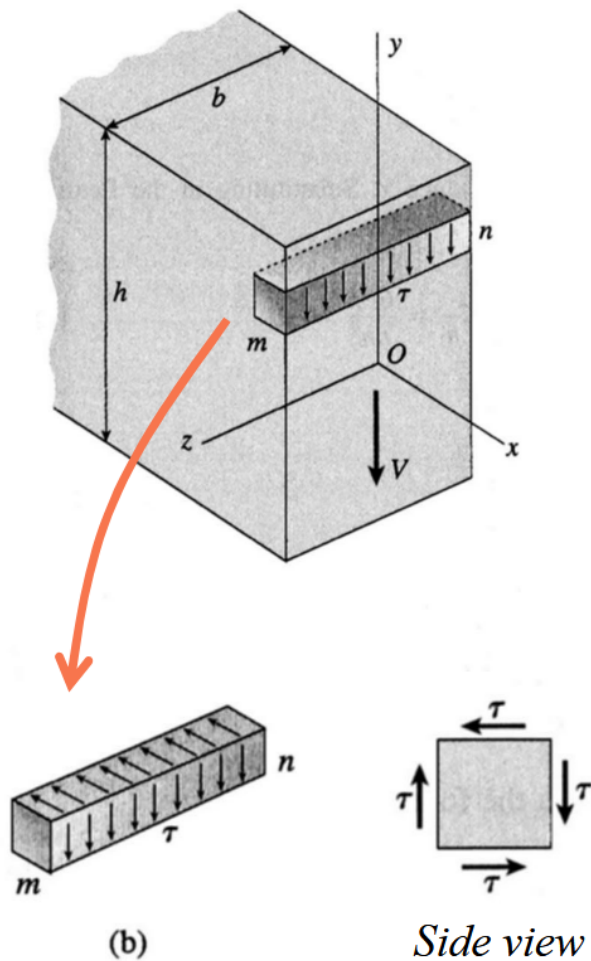
Note: While the internal shear force V introduces a shear stress τ in the beam cross-section, it is usually negligible compared to the bending stress σ and thus is not considered in the beam design for strength (the elastic flexure formula is still valid with shear forces). However, the presence of shear forces does introduce other modes of failure which we will discuss in the next section.

Shear Stress in Beams

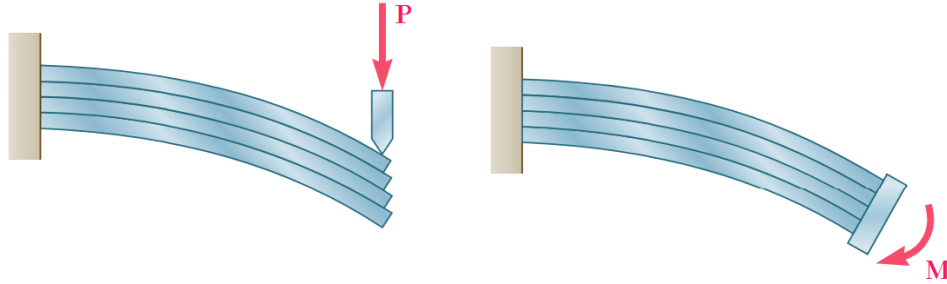
For shear beam analysis we will use a slightly different coordinate system to maintain consistency with the directions of the internal shear force and shear stress.



A vertical internal shear force V is the resultant of a distribution of vertical shear stresses τ across the cross-section of the beam. However, to maintain equilibrium, the vertical shear stresses must have a complementary horizontal shear stress parallel to the top and bottom surfaces of the beam. This follows the 3D state of stress discussed previously.



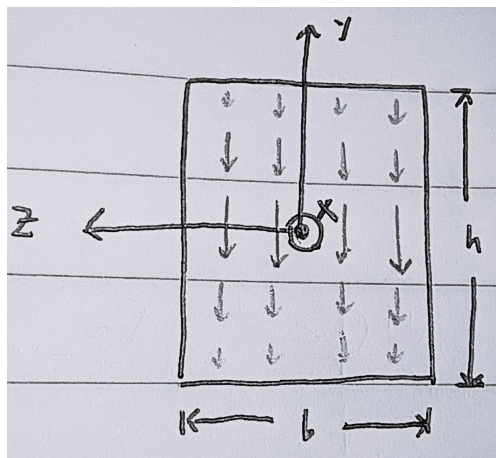
To visualize the horizontal shear stresses, consider the following set of sheets. When an external shear force is applied, the sheets will tend to slide past each other (left figure). Thus, if these sheets were glued together and unable to slide, internal shear stresses would develop in between each layer. These shear stresses don't exist in when an external moment is applied, since the sheets will be in pure bending and thus only experience normal stresses (right figure).



Shear Stress Distribution

The average shear stress across the cross-section is given as $\tau_{\text{avg}} = \frac{V}{A}$. However, since the shear stress MUST be zero at the free surfaces of the beam (the top and bottom surfaces), the shear stress distribution is not uniform across the cross-section. Instead, we use the formula below to define the shear stress distribution across the cross-section:

$$\tau(x, y) = \frac{V(x)Q(y)}{Ib}$$



Where:

- $V(x)$ is the internal shear force at the cross-section at x along the beam
- I is the second area moment of the cross-section about the neutral axis
- b is the width of the cross section

- $Q(y)$ is the first area moment of the area above (or below) the point y about the neutral axis. It is defined as:

$$Q(y) = \int y dA = A'\bar{y}$$

The first area moment $Q(y)$ is the area of the cross-section above the axis of interest (A') multiplied by the distance from the neutral axis to the centroid of that area ($\bar{y}$).

For the rectangular cross-section shown, the shear stress distribution is:

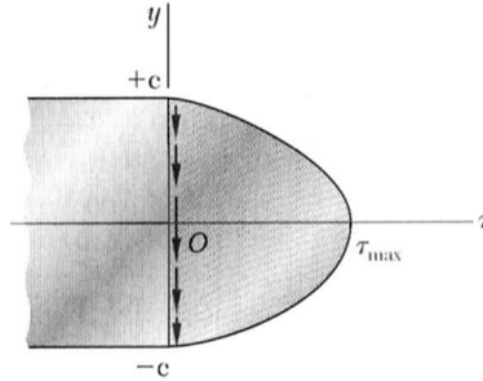
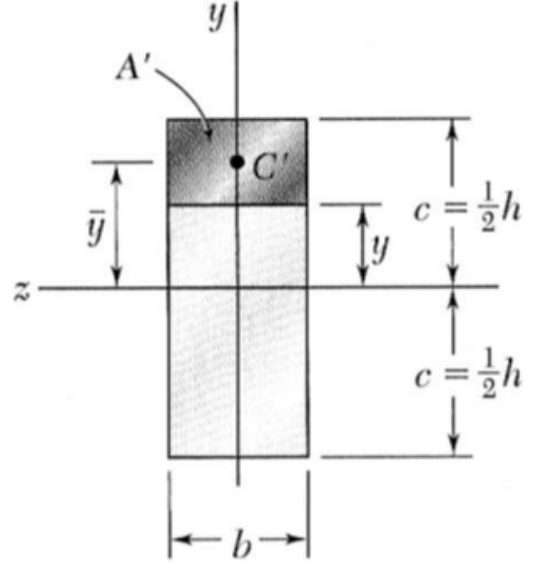
$$Q(y) = b(c - y) \cdot \left[c - \frac{1}{2}(c - y) \right] = \frac{b}{2}(c^2 - y^2)$$

$$I = \frac{1}{12}bh^3 = \frac{2}{3}bc^3$$

$$\tau = \frac{VQ}{Ib} = \frac{V \frac{b}{2}(c^2 - y^2)}{\frac{2}{3}b^2c^3} = \frac{3V}{4bc^3}(c^2 - y^2)$$

$$\Rightarrow \tau = \frac{3V}{2A} \left(1 - \frac{y^2}{c^2} \right)$$

Plotting the shear stress distribution across the cross-section, we see that the max shear stress occurs at the neutral axis

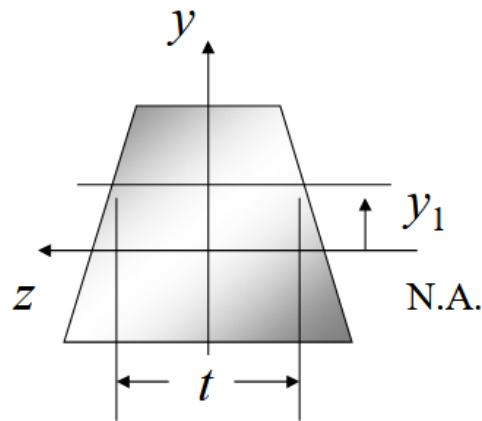


Average Shear Stress

The previous equation for shear stress distribution ($\tau = VQ/Ib$) is only valid for rectangular cross-sections, since we can make the assumption that the width b is constant across the cross-section. For non-rectangular cross-sections, we can use the average shear stress instead:

$$\tau_{\text{avg}}(y_1) = \frac{V(x)Q(y_1)}{It(y_1)}$$

Where $t(y_1)$ is the width of the cross-section at the point y_1 where we want to find the shear stress, its basically b from before, but now it can vary across the cross-section.



Shear Flow

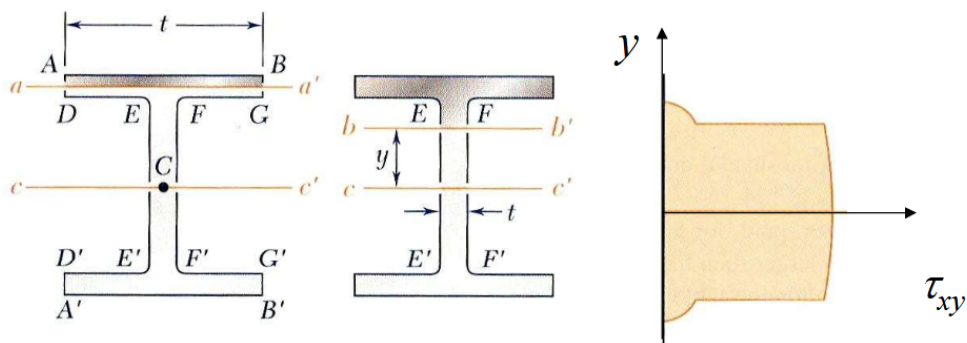
Using our more generalized average shear stress equation, we defined the shear flow q as the horizontal shear load per unit length.

$$q = \frac{\Delta H}{\Delta x} = \frac{\tau_{\text{avg}} t \Delta x}{\Delta x} = \tau_{\text{avg}} t$$

$$q = \frac{VQ}{I}$$

Vertical Shear Distributions in I-Beams

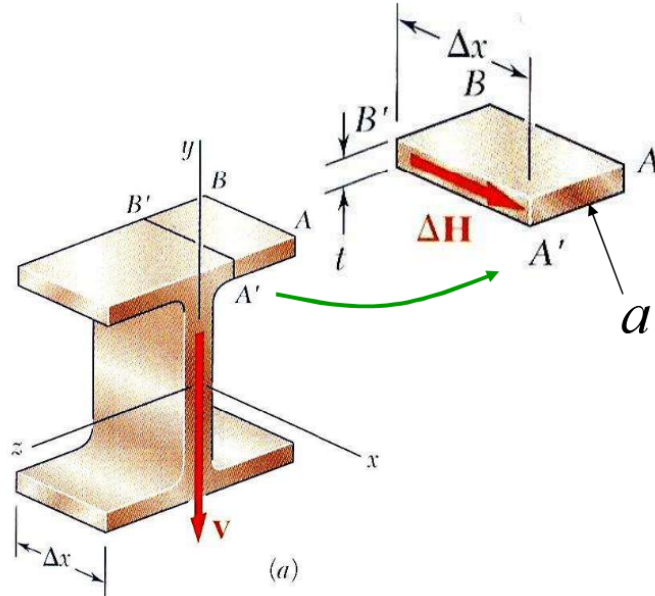
Using the average shear stress equation, we can find that the vertical shear in the flanges are very small (large b and small Q), while the vertical shear in the web is very large (small b and large Q). Thus, we can assume that the vertical shear is almost entirely carried by the web of the I-beam, while the flanges carry mostly bending stresses.



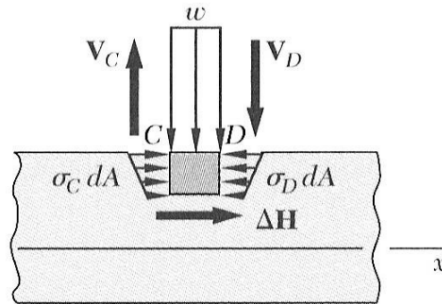
Longitudinal Shear Stress τ_{zx}

Instead of looking at the vertical shear stress in the cross-sections parallel to the y-z plane, we can also look at the longitudinal shear stress in the cross-sections parallel to the x-y plane.

Note that this longitudinal shear stress is NOT the same as the horizontal shear stress τ_{yx} discussed earlier, instead this longitudinal shear stress acts on a different face of the beam element.



Without getting too deep into the derivations, this longitudinal shear stress is the result of the bending moment M varying along the length of the beam. Thus, in order to maintain static equilibrium on an infinitesimal section of the beam, there must be a horizontal shear load ΔH acting on the cross-section. This horizontal shear load is the resultant of the longitudinal shear stress τ_{zx} across the cross-section.

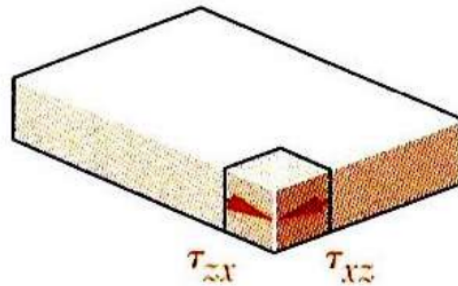


Using the shear flow equation, we can now define the longitudinal shear stress as:

$$q = \frac{\Delta H}{\Delta x} = \frac{VQ}{I}, \quad Q = a\bar{y}$$

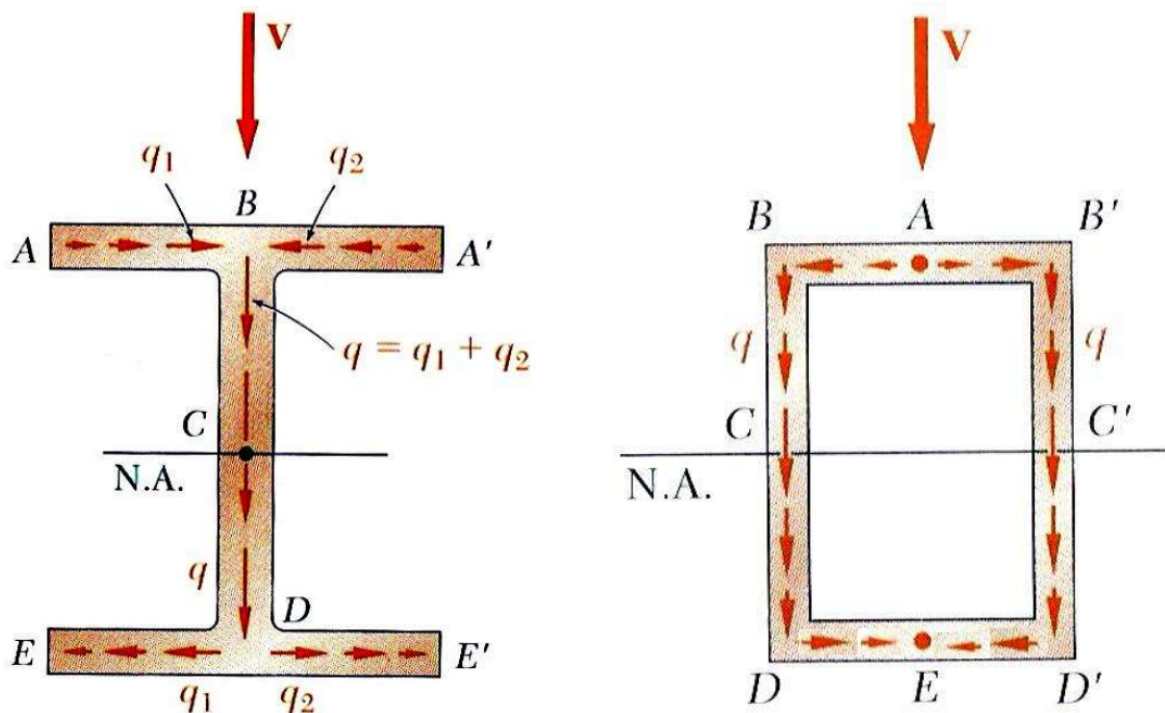
$$\tau_{zx} = \frac{\Delta H}{\Delta x t} = \frac{q}{t}$$

By shear stress symmetry, we can also say that $\tau_{zx} = \tau_{xz}$. Thus explaining where the sideways shear stress comes from in the flange of the I-beam shown later.



Shear Flow in Thin Walled Sections

Shown above, the shear stress and thus shear flow can flow through the section of a thin-walled section parallel to the free surfaces.



Note that this section needs work, I'm not fully sure about my understanding of shear flow in thin-walled sections yet.

"While the longitudinal force imbalance from dM/dx exists in all sections under shear, sideways shear stress (τ_{xz}) is primarily significant in the thin, projecting flanges of thin-walled profiles. In solid sections (like solid rectangles), the free vertical edges force $\tau_{xz} = 0$ at the surfaces, and symmetry forces $\tau_{xz} = 0$ along the centerline, leaving vertical shear (τ_{xy}) to carry almost the entire shear resultant." (-Gemini)

Design of Beams for Deflection

Differential Equation Method

Assuming small static deflections of a slender beam, we can say that

$$y \ll L, \quad \frac{dy}{dx} \ll 1$$

Using the elastic flexure formula, we can relate the curvature of the beam to the bending moment at any point along the beam:

$$\frac{1}{\rho} = \frac{M(x)}{EI}$$

From calculus, the curvature of any continuous function is given as:

$$\frac{1}{\rho} = \frac{\frac{d^2y}{dx^2}}{\left[1 + \left(\frac{dy}{dx}\right)^2\right]^{3/2}}$$

Since we are assuming small deflections, we can say that $\left(\frac{dy}{dx}\right)^2 \ll 1$, and thus the curvature simplifies to:

$$\frac{1}{\rho} \approx \frac{d^2y}{dx^2}$$

Bringing back in the elastic flexure formula, we can relate the bending moment to the deflection of the beam:

$$\boxed{\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} = \frac{M(x)}{EI}}$$

By doing double integration and using the boundary conditions of the beam, we can find the deflection $y(x)$ along the length of the beam and the slope $y'(x) = \theta(x)$ at any point along the beam.

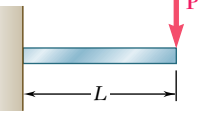
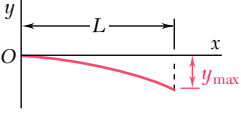
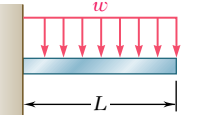
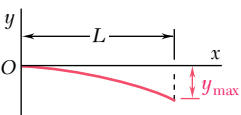
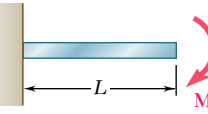
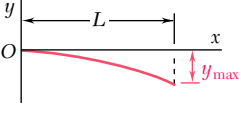
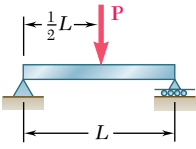
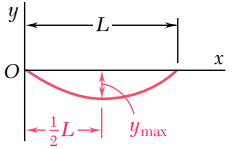
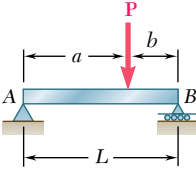
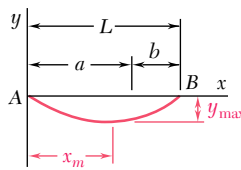
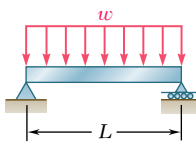
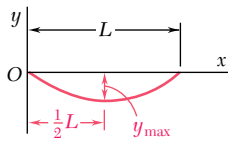
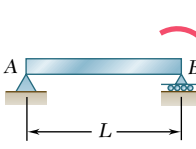
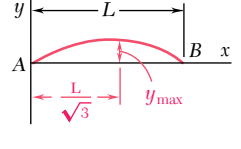
$$y(x) = \int \int \frac{M(x)}{EI} dx dx + c_1x + c_2$$

Note: For an external shear force, deflections $\propto L^3$, while for an external bending moment, deflections $\propto L^2$.

Superposition Method

Since integration is also a linear operation, we can use superposition to find the deflection of a beam under multiple loads. We can isolate each external load/moment and find the deflection due to each load/moment separately. Then, we can sum the deflections to find the total deflection of the beam. Note that max deflection must be found after summing the deflections from each load/moment, since the max deflection may not occur at the same location for each loading.

APPENDIX D Beam Deflections and Slopes

Beam and Loading	Elastic Curve	Maximum Deflection	Slope at End	Equation of Elastic Curve
1 		$-\frac{PL^3}{3EI}$	$-\frac{PL^2}{2EI}$	$y = \frac{P}{6EI}(x^3 - 3Lx^2)$
2 		$-\frac{wL^4}{8EI}$	$-\frac{wL^3}{6EI}$	$y = -\frac{w}{24EI}(x^4 - 4Lx^3 + 6L^2x^2)$
3 		$-\frac{ML^2}{2EI}$	$-\frac{ML}{EI}$	$y = -\frac{M}{2EI}x^2$
4 		$-\frac{PL^3}{48EI}$	$\pm \frac{PL^2}{16EI}$	For $x \leq \frac{1}{2}L$: $y = \frac{P}{48EI}(4x^3 - 3L^2x)$
5 		For $a > b$: $-\frac{Pb(L^2 - b^2)^{3/2}}{9\sqrt{3}EIL}$ at $x_m = \sqrt{\frac{L^2 - b^2}{3}}$	$\theta_A = -\frac{Pb(L^2 - b^2)}{6EIL}$ $\theta_B = +\frac{Pa(L^2 - a^2)}{6EIL}$	For $x < a$: $y = \frac{Pb}{6EIL}[x^3 - (L^2 - b^2)x]$ For $x = a$: $y = -\frac{Pa^2b^2}{3EIL}$
6 		$-\frac{5wL^4}{384EI}$	$\pm \frac{wL^3}{24EI}$	$y = -\frac{w}{24EI}(x^4 - 2Lx^3 + L^3x)$
7 		$\frac{ML^2}{9\sqrt{3}EI}$	$\theta_A = +\frac{ML}{6EI}$ $\theta_B = -\frac{ML}{3EI}$	$y = -\frac{M}{6EIL}(x^3 - L^2x)$

Stress Transformations and Failure Criteria

Stress transformation due to changes in the material orientation.

Eqns for normal and shear stresses along different orientations.

Mohr's circle for stress transformation: find principal stresses and max shear stress.

Mohr's circle for 3d stress state

Failure criteria: ductile isotropic materials: Tresca and von Mises. Brittle materials: Mohr's criterion.

Buckling of Columns